Ranking and Accreditation of HEIs: Frameworks, Processes and Best Practices

Dr. GOVERDHAN REDDY TURPU

Associate Professor
Former Coordinator, IQAC- GGV
Guru Ghasidas Vishwavidyalaya (A Central University)
Koni, Bilaspur, Chhattisgarh, INDIA

dr.tgreddy@gmail.com , tg.reddy@ggu.ac.in

Contents of the Presentation

1. What is accreditation and Ranking - an Overview
2. NIRF Data flow and Understanding
3. Comparative Understanding of 2025 NIRF Rankings – Possible strategies for preparations
4. NAAC – Accreditation
5. NAAC Criteria for accreditation – Procedural Flow
6. IQAC and it's role in the implementation of Quality Assurance
7. Best practices – to improve the Rankings

RANKING : (Who is the Best?)

comparing institutions against one another on a competitive ladder or scoreboard based on specific criteria like research
output, reputation, and global impact

Example: THE, QS, Shanghai and NIRF (Indian)

Accreditation: (Suitability)

seal, certificate, or stamp awarded by an authorized governing body confirming that an institution meets established quality standards and regulatory benchmarks.

Example: NBA, NAAC, PCI, etc.

Who is The Best?



•**THE World University Rankings:** Oxford has held the **#1 position globally for 11 consecutive years** (from the 2017 edition through the 2027 edition), which is the longest uninterrupted run at the top in the history of the THE rankings.

•**QS World University Rankings:** Oxford has maintained a steady position within the global top 6, reaching a peak rank of **#2** in the 2022 edition, and consistently occupying **#3 or #4** in recent years.

•**QS Rankings:** Stanford held the **#2** position globally for five consecutive years (2017–2021) before dipping slightly to #5–#6 between 2024 and 2025. It quickly recovered to **#3** in 2026 and **#2** in the 2027 edition.

•**THE Rankings:** Stanford has consistently fluctuated within the global top 6, reaching a peak of **#2** in the 2021 and 2024 editions and settling at **#3 (joint)** in the 2027 edition.

Then why me..Is it worth trying ?



Can someone, with efforts, make themselves better?

University	Country	Key Ranking Breakthrough	Peak Global Rank	Strategic Driver
National University of Singapore (NUS)	Singapore	First Asian university in QS Top 10	#8 (QS)	Government funding, global faculty recruiting, high employability
ETH Zurich	Switzerland	Top Continental European disrupter	#7 (QS)	Precision engineering research, citation density, state-of-the-art labs
Tsinghua University	China	Rapid ascent toward THE Top 10	#11 (THE)	Massive research output, industrial patents, state backing



Why Ranking or Accreditation ?



Visib ility

Ran king

Accredi tation

Process develop ment

Data manage ment

Analyzing through AQAR

Next cycle – checking your processes

A method to improve your quality and keep it sustained

Recognized Accreditor



Accredited by NAAC

A++ (Score-3.62)

A++



UGC Graded Autonomy

Category-1 University

Category-I

NBA NATIONAL BOARD OF ACCREDITATION

PROMOTING INTERNATIONAL QUALITY STANDARDS FOR TECHNICAL EDUCATION IN INDIA

PHARMACY COUNCIL OF INDIA

A statutory body under the Ministry of Health & Family Welfare

Government of India

Who's Authentic ?

The Rankings and accreditation are of GURU GHASIDAS VISHWAVIDYALAYA, BIALSPUR

THE

THE World Ranking

401-500 Rank Band

401-500

THE

THE Asia Ranking

600+ Rank Band

600+

QS WORLD UNIVERSITY RANKINGS

QS Ranking

South Asia : 263

Asia : 801-850

QS

Indian Ranking System:

National Institutional Ranking Framework (NIRF)", on September 29, 2015

	Categories		Subject domains
1	Overall	1	Engineering
2	Universities	2	Management
3	Colleges	3	Pharmacy
4	Research Institutions	4	Architecture & Planning
5	Innovation	5	Law
6	State Public Universities	6	Medical
7	Open Universities	7	Dental
8	Skill Universities	8	Agriculture & Allied Sectors
9	Sustainable Development Goals (SDGs)		

The Ministry acknowledges with gratitude the contributions made by the National Board of Accreditation (NBA) and for its unwavering commitment and dedication to executing this formidable task annually. The NIRF Team at NBA, in collaboration with the INFLIBNET Centre in Gandhinagar, has been instrumental in the successful execution of this scheme.

Who's Participating ?

Category / Discipline	North	South	East	West	Total
Overall	602	1452	574	1417	4045
Engineering	219	769	152	444	1584
Management	209	367	95	355	1026
Pharmacy	118	184	44	248	594
Architecture & Planning	26	47	9	49	131
Colleges	554	1230	759	1487	4030
Medical	51	93	16	63	223
Law	85	37	38	107	267
Research Institutions	71	119	28	55	273
Dental	47	102	14	60	223
Agriculture & Allied Sectors	48	47	23	55	173
Innovation	125	416	58	178	777
Open Universities	4	3	3	5	15
Skill Universities	1	3	2	5	11
SDGs Institutions	144	399	74	174	791
Total	2304	5268	1889	4702	14163

Table 3: Region-wise Participation of Institutions in India Rankings 2025

Parameters and their importance

Summary of Ranking Parameters and Weightages- 2025
(Overall)

Sr. No.	Parameter	Marks	Weightage
1	Teaching, Learning & Resources	100	0.30
2	Research and Professional Practice	100	0.30
3	Graduation Outcomes	100	0.20
4	Outreach and Inclusivity	100	0.10
5	Perception	100	0.10

Among the five NIRF Parameters RP demonstrates the strongest correlation with overall ranking, highlight ling the centrality of research in Institutional excellence

Universities – Overall

Overall

S. No.	Parameters	Marks
1.	**Teaching, Learning & Resources (TLR)** **Ranking weight: 0.30**	100
	A. Student Strength including Doctoral Students (SS): 20 marks B. Faculty-student ratio with emphasis on permanent faculty (FSR)#: 25 marks C. Combined metric for Faculty with PhD (or equivalent) and Experience (FQE): 20 marks D. Financial Resources and their Utilisation (FRU): 20 marks E. Online Education: Online Completion of Syllabus & Exams and Swayam (OE): 10 marks F. Combined metric for Multiple Entry/Exit, Indian Knowledge System, Regional languages, and Sustainable Living Practices (MIRS): 5 marks	
2.	**Research and Professional Practice (RP)** **Ranking weight: 0.30**	100
	A. Combined metric for Publications (PU): 35 marks B. Combined metric for Quality of Publications (QP): 35 marks C. IPR and Patents: Published and Granted (IPR): 15 marks D. Footprint of Projects and Professional Practice (FPPP): 15 marks	
3.	**Graduation Outcomes (GO)** **Ranking weight: 0.20**	100
	A. Metric for University Examinations(GUE): 60 marks B. Metric for Number of Ph.D. Students Graduated (GPHD): 40 marks	
4.	**Outreach and Inclusivity (OI)** **Ranking weight: 0.10**	100
	A. Percentage of Students from Other States/Countries (Region Diversity RD): 30 marks B. Percentage of Women (Women Diversity WD): 30 marks C. Economically and Socially Challenged Students (ESCS): 20 marks D. Facilities for Physically Challenged Students (PCS): 20 marks	
5.	**Perception (PR)*** **Ranking weight: 0.10**	100
	A. Peer Perception: Academic Peers and Employers (PR): 100 marks	

For State Public Universities, the Faculty Student Ratio (FSR) is considered based on 1:20.
* For Universities and State Public Universities, in the Perception parameter, 70% weight is given to Peer Perception and 30% to Accreditation

Engineering

Engineering

S.No.	Parameters	Marks
1.	**Teaching, Learning & Resources (TLR)** **Ranking weight: 0.30**	100
	A. Student Strength including Doctoral Students(SS): 20 marks B. Faculty-student ratio with emphasis on permanent faculty (FSR): 30 marks C. Combined metric for Faculty with PhD (or equivalent) and Experience (FQE): 20 marks D. Financial Resources and their Utilisation (FRU): 30 marks	
2.	**Research and Professional Practice (RP)** **Ranking weight: 0.30**	100
	A. Combined metric for Publications (PU): 35 marks B. Combined metric for Quality of Publications (QP): 40 marks C. IPR and Patents: Published and Granted (IPR): 15 marks D. Footprint of Projects and Professional Practice (FPPP): 10 marks	
3.	**Graduation Outcomes (GO)** **Ranking weight: 0.20**	100
	A. Combined metric for Placement and Higher Studies (GPH): 40 marks B. Metric for University Examinations (GUE): 15 marks C. Median Salary (GMS): 25 marks D. Metric for Number of Ph.D. Students Graduated (GPHD): 20 marks	
4.	**Outreach and Inclusivity (OI)** **Ranking weight: 0.10**	100
	A. Percentage of Students from other States/Countries (Region Diversity RD): 30 marks B. Percentage of Women (Women Diversity WD): 30 marks C. Economically and Socially Challenged Students (ESCS): 20 marks D. Facilities for Physically Challenged Students (PCS): 20 marks	
5.	**Perception (PR)** **Ranking weight: 0.10**	100
	A. Peer Perception: Employers & Academic Peer (PR): 100 marks	

Colleges

r.No.	Parameters	Marks
1.	**Teaching, Learning & Resources (TLR)** **Ranking weight: 0.40**	100
	A. Student Strength (SS): 20 marks B. Faculty-student ratio with emphasis on permanent faculty (FSR): 30 marks C. Combined metric for Faculty with PhD (or equivalent) and Experience (FQE): 20 marks D. Financial Resources and their Utilisation (FRU): 30 marks	
2.	**Research and Professional Practice (RP)** **Ranking weight: 0.15**	100
	A. Combined metric for Publications (PU): 70 marks B. Combined metric for Quality of Publications (QP): 30 marks	
3.	**Graduation Outcomes (GO)** **Ranking weight: 0.25**	100
	A. Combined metric for Placement and Higher Studies(GPH): 40 marks B. Metric for University Examinations(GUE): 40 marks C. Median Salary(GMS): 20 marks	
4.	**Outreach and Inclusivity (OI)** **Ranking weight: 0.10**	100
	A. Percentage of Students from Other States/Countries (Region Diversity RD): 30 marks B. Percentage of Women (Women Diversity WD): 30 marks C. Economically and Socially Challenged Students (ESCS): 20 marks D. Facilities for Physically Challenged Students (PCS): 20 marks	
5.	**Perception (PR)** **Ranking weight: 0.10**	100
	A. Peer Perception: Employers & Academic Peer (PR): 100 marks	

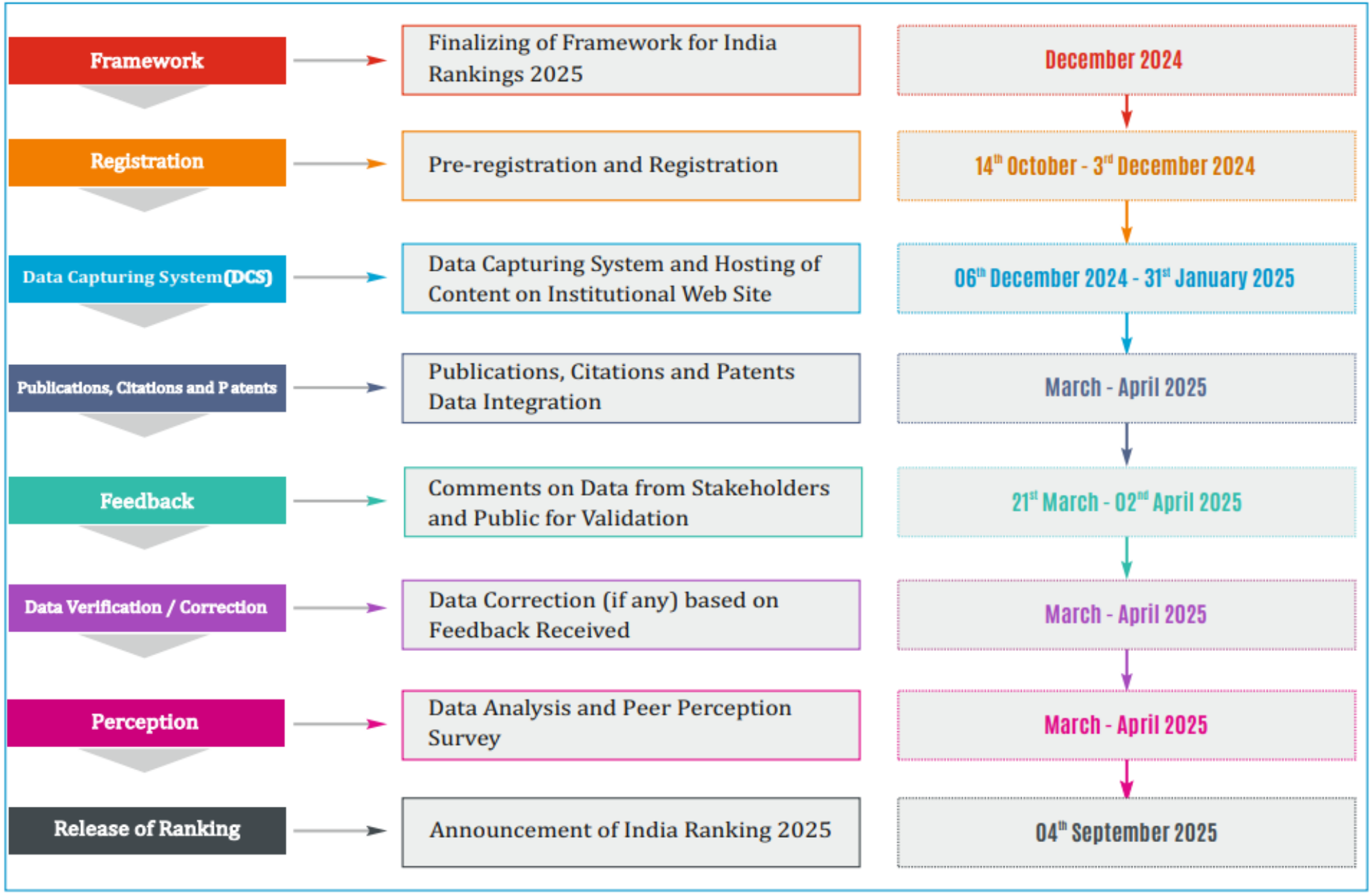


Fig. 2. India Rankings 2025: Activity Calendar



Teaching, Learning & Resources (0.30)

- Student Strength (20)
- Faculty Student Ratio (25)
- Faculty with Ph.D (20)
- Financial Resources & Utilisation (20)
- Online Education (10)
- Multiple Entry/Exit, Indian Knowledge System and Regional languages (5)

Student Strength including Doctoral Students (SS)

A. Student Strength including Ph.D. students (SS): 20 Marks

- $\mathbf{SS = f(N_T, N_E) \times 15 + f(N_P) \times 5}$

- The functions $f(N_T, N_E)$ and $f(N_p)$ are functions to be determined by NIRF.
- *N_T: Total sanctioned approved intake in the institution considering all UG and PG programs of the institution.*
- *N_E: Total number of students enrolled in the institution considering all UG and PG programs of the institution.*
- N_p = Total number of students enrolled for the doctoral program till previous academic year.

- ***Primary Data: To be provided in a prescribed Format.***

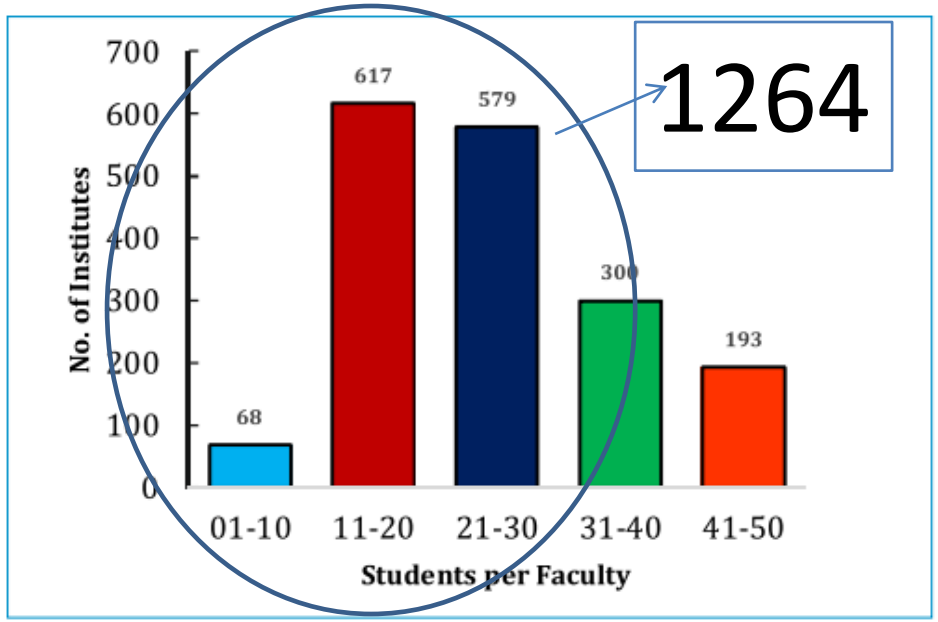
Teaching, Learning & Resources (0.30)

- Student Strength (20)
- Faculty Student Ratio (25)
- Faculty with Ph.D (20)
- Financial Resources & Utilisation (20)
- Online Education (10)
- Multiple Entry/Exit, Indian Knowledge System and Regional languages (5)

Faculty-student ratio with emphasis on permanent faculty (FSR)

B. Faculty-Student Ratio with emphasis on permanent faculty (FSR): 30 marks

- **FSR = 30 × [15 × (F/N)]**
- $N = N_T + N_p$
- F: Full time regular faculty in the institution in the previous year.
- Regular appointment means Faculty on Full time basis. *Faculty on contract basis/ad-hoc basis will be considered if the concerned faculty has taught in both the semesters of academic year 2017-18.*
- Faculty members with Ph.D. and Masters degree will be considered and counted here. Faculty member with a Bachelor's degree will not be counted.
- Expected ratio is 1:15 to score maximum marks.
- **For F/N < 1: 50, FSR will be set to zero.**



Teaching, Learning & Resources (0.30)

- Student Strength (20)
- Faculty Student Ratio (25)
- Faculty with Ph.D (20)
- Financial Resources & Utilisation (20)
- Online Education (10)
- Multiple Entry/Exit, Indian Knowledge System and Regional languages (5)

Combined metric for Faculty with PhD (or equivalent) and Experience (FQE)

C. Combined Metric for Faculty with PhD (or equivalent) and Experience (FQE): 20 marks

- $FQ = 10 \times (F_{RA}/95)$, $F_{RA} < 95\%$;
- $FQ = 10$, $F_{RA} \geq 95\%$.

- *Here F_{RA} is the percentage of Faculty with Ph.D. (or equivalent qualification) with respect to the total no. of faculty required or actual faculty whichever is higher, in the previous year.*

F1=Fraction with Experience up to 8 years;

F2= Fraction with Experience between 8+ to 15years;

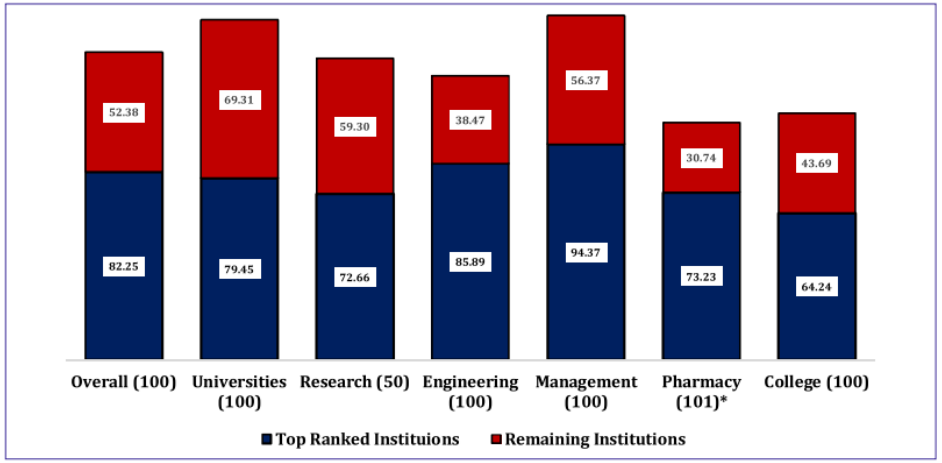
F3=Fraction with Experience > 15 years.

FE = 3min(3F1, 1) + 3 min(3F2, 1) + 4 min(3F3, 1)

Rationale: Full marks for a ratio of 1:1:1

- **FQE = FQ + FE**

- ***Primary Data: Faculty List in the Prescribed Format.***



Distribution of Faculty with Ph.D. in the 100 Top-Ranked Institutions as Compared to Faculty with Ph.D. in Remaining Eligible Institutions in Various Categories and Subject Domains

Teaching, Learning & Resources (0.30)

- Student Strength (20)
- Faculty Student Ratio (25)
- Faculty with Ph.D (20)
- Financial Resources & Utilisation (20)
- Online Education (10)
- Multiple Entry/Exit, Indian Knowledge System and Regional languages (5)

Combined metric for Faculty with PhD (or equivalent) and Experience (FQE)

Experience in Years	No. of Faculty	%
Faculty with up to 8 Years of Experience	1118465	34.17
Faculty with >8 to 15 Years of Experience	102581	29.59
Faculty with >=15 Years of Experience	125625	36.24
Total	346671	

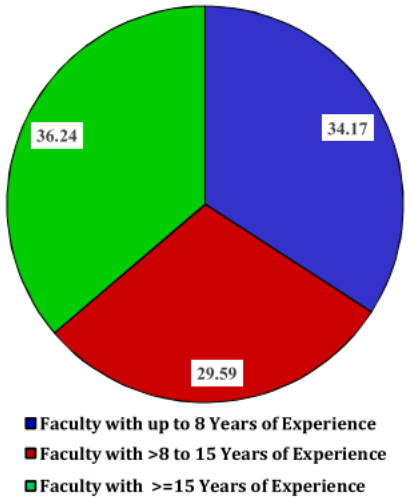
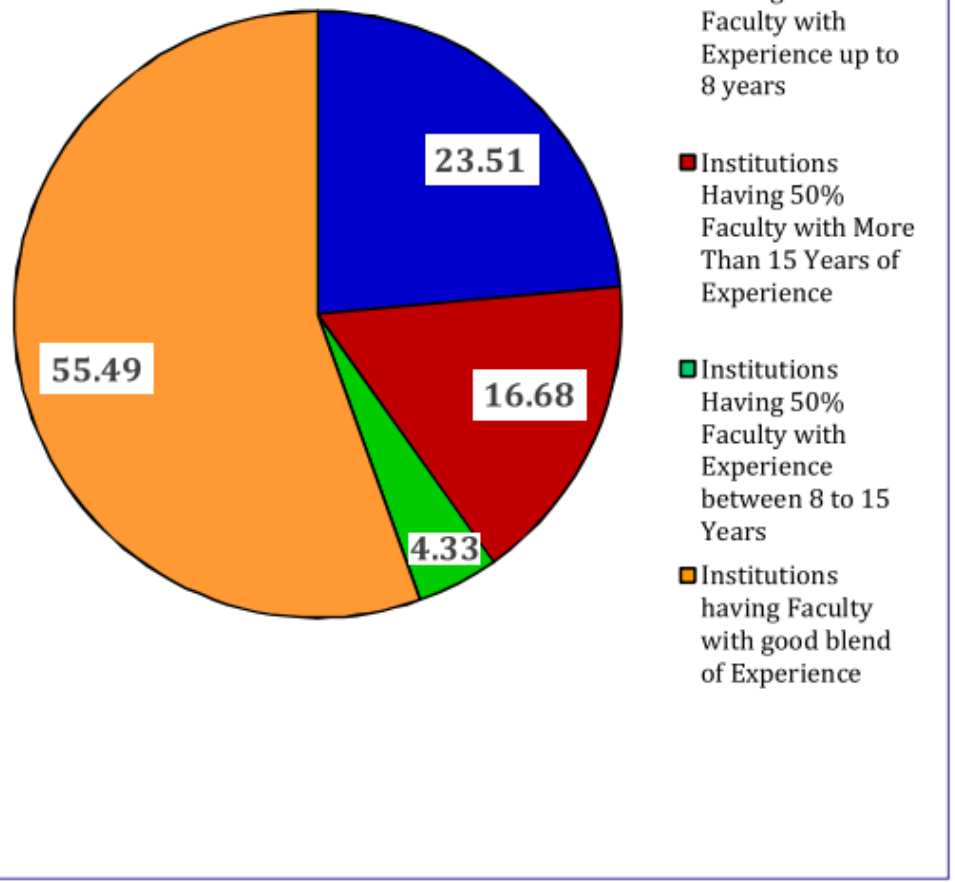


Table 6 and Fig. 5: Experience Profiles of Faculty in Eligible Institutions in Overall Category



Teaching, Learning & Resources (0.30)

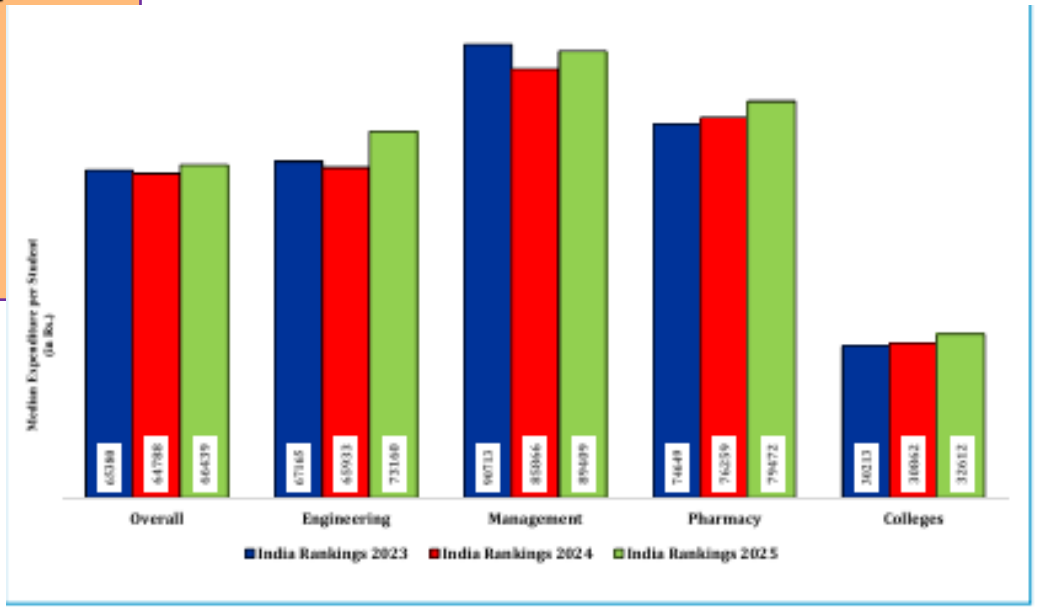
- Student Strength (20)
- Faculty Student Ratio (25)
- Faculty with Ph.D (20)
- Financial Resources & Utilisation (20)
- Online Education (10)
- Multiple Entry/Exit, Indian Knowledge System and Regional languages (5)

Financial Resources and their Utilisation (FRU)

D: Financial Resources and their Utilisation (FRU): 30 Marks

- **FRU = 7.5×f(BC) + 22.5×f(BO)**
- BC: Average Annual Capital Expenditure per student for the previous three years. **(Excluding expenditure on construction of new buildings)**
- BO: Average Annual Operational (or Recurring) Expenditure per student for the previous three years. **(Excluding maintenance of hostels and allied services)**
- ***Primary Data: Figures in prescribed format for each.***

Category / Domain	India Rankings			% Increase % Decrease
	2023	2024	2025	
	Amount in Rs.			
Overall	65380	64788	66439	1.62
Engineering	67165	65933	73160	8.93
Management	90713	85866	89409	-1.44
Pharmacy	74649	76259	79472	6.46
Colleges	30213	30862	32612	7.94





Teaching, Learning & Resources (0.30)

- Student Strength (20)
- Faculty Student Ratio (25)
- Faculty with Ph.D (20)
- Financial Resources & Utilisation (20)
- Online Education (10)
- Multiple Entry/Exit, Indian Knowledge System and Regional languages (5)

Online Education(OE)

E: Online Education: Online Completion of Syllabus & Exams and Swayam (OE): 10 marks

- **OE = f(OE)**

Multiple Entry/Exit, Indian Knowledge System and Regional languages (MIR)

F: Combined metric for Multiple Entry/Exit, Indian Knowledge System and Regional languages (MIR): 5 marks

- **MIR = 2 × MEE + 2 × IKS + 1 ×RL**

- MEE = Implementation of Multiple Entry/Exit
- IKS = Introduction of courses of Indian Knowledge System
- RL = Courses being offered in Regional Languages

- Publications (35)
- Citations (35)
- Patents (15)
- Research Projects (15)

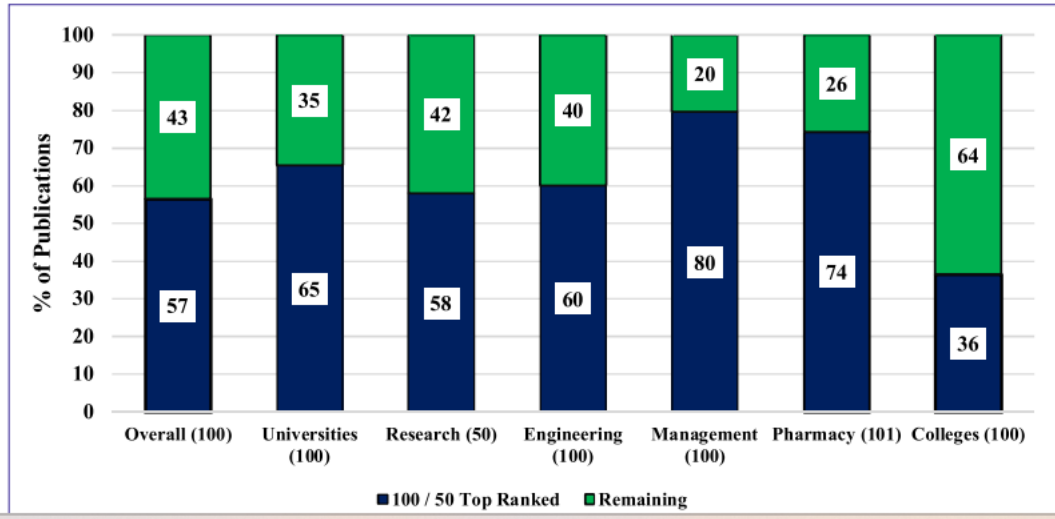
Research and Professional Practice (0.30)

Combined metric for Publications (PU)

A.Combined metric for Publications (PU): 35 marks

- $PU = 35 \times f(P/F_{RQ})$

- *P is weighted number of publications as acertained from suitable third party sources.*
- F_{RQ} *is the maximum of nominal number of faculty members as calculated on the basis of a required FSR of 1:15 or the available faculty in the institution.*
- **Sources: Third party sources.**



No. of Eligible Inst.	Discipline / & (No. of Top -Ranked Inst.)	Publications			% of Publications		Average No. of Publications		
		Total	100 / 50 Top Ranked	Remaining	100 / 50 Top Ranked	Remaining	Top 100 / 50	Remaining	All Eligible
1757	Overall (100)	611693	345990	265703	56.56	43.44	3459.90	160.35	348.15
506	Universities (100)	382638	250565	132073	65.48	34.52	2505.65	325.30	756.20
229	Research (50)	454698	263767	190931	58.01	41.99	5275.34	1066.65	1985.58
1489	Engineering (100)	275820	165989	109831	60.18	39.82	1659.89	79.07	185.24
909	Management (100)	8304	6610	1694	79.60	20.40	66.10	2.09	9.14
538	Pharmacy (101)	13410	9966	3444	74.32	25.68	98.67	7.88	24.93
1821	Colleges (100)	34940	12741	22199	36.47	63.53	127.41	12.90	19.19

Table 10: Research Publications of the 100 Top-Ranked Institutions as Compared to the Rest of the Eligible Institutions in Various Categories / Subject Domains

- Publications (35)
- Citations (35)
- Patents (15)
- Research Projects (15)

Research and Professional Practice (0.30)



Combined metric for Publications (PU)

Categories / Domains	Institutes/ Publications	Most Productive	Medium Productive	Low Productive	Least Productive	"0" Publications	Total
Overall	HEIs	20	53	128	1420	136	1757
	Publications	157757	154133	153061	146742	0	611693
Universities	HEIs	14	35	82	375	0	506
	Publications	99566	97526	96188	89358	0	382638
Research Institutions	HEIs	12	24	52	140	0	229
	Publications	117840	114042	114934	107882	0	454698
Engineering	HEIs	16	42	122	1220	89	1489
	Publications	70742	69161	68955	66962	0	275820
Management	HEIs	12	22	42	303	530	909
	Publications	2157	2099	2100	1948	0	8304
Pharmacy	HEIs	12	23	55	360	88	538
	Publications	3409	3462	3359	3180	0	13410
Architecture & Planning	HEIs	1	3	5	14	100	123
	Publications	14	15	14	14	0	57
Medical	HEIs	4	12	25	140	1	182
	Publications	25241	24779	23516	19906	0	93442
Dental	HEIs	4	19	45	142	8	218
	Publications	1054	1055	1032	958	0	4099
Agriculture & Allied Sec.	HEIs	4	10	20	82	10	126
	Publications	4770	4555	4594	4042	0	17961
Law	HEIs	3	5	13	23	106	150
	Publications	86	66	64	37	0	253
Colleges	HEIs	40	187	187	934	573	1821
	Publications	8860	8827	8751	8555	0	34940

Table 11.Comparative Research Output of Institutions in Various Categories and Subject Domains: The Least Productive to the Most Productive Institutions

Discipline / Category	No. of Research Publications		
	World (1)	India (2)	Eligible Institutions
Overall	10930980	589278 5.39 % of (1)	611693 103.8 % of (2)
Engineering	3323292	248136 7.47 % of (1)	275820 111.16 % of (2)
Management	137864	9303 6.75 % of (1)	8304 89.26 % of (2)
Pharmacy	281396	21119 7.51 % of (1)	13410 63.50 % of (2)

Table 14: Research Publications of Eligible Institutions in Comparison to the Total Research Publications of the World and India

- Publications (35)
- Citations (35)
- Patents (15)
- Research Projects (15)

Research and Professional Practice (0.30)

Combined metric for Quality of Publications (QP)

B.Combined metric for Quality of Publications (QP): 35 Marks

- $QP = 20 \times f(CC/F_{RQ}) + 15 \times f(TOP25P/P)$
- Here CC is Total Citation Count over previous three years.
- P is as computed for PU.
- TOP25P: Number of citations in top 25 percentile averaged over the previous three years.
- F_{RQ} *is the maximum of nominal number of faculty members as calculated on the basis of a required FSR of 1:15 or the available faculty in the institution.*

No. of Eligible Inst.	Discipline / Categories	Top 100 Institutions	Number of Highly Cited Publications (HCP)		% of HCP	
			100 Top Ranked Institutions	Remaining	100 Top Ranked Institutes	Remaining Institutes
1757	Overall (100)	155328	89506	65822	57.62	42.38
506	Universities (100)	97108	64091	33017	66.00	34.00
229	Research Inst. (50)	116969	69653	47316	59.55	40.45
1489	Engineering (100)	71054	45044	26010	63.39	36.61
909	Management (100)	2143	1737	406	81.05	18.95
538	Pharmacy (50)	2129	1738	391	81.63	18.37

Table 13: Highly Cited Publications of the 100 Top-Ranked Institutions as Compared to the Remaining Eligible Institutions in Various Categories / Subject Domains

No. of Eligible Inst.	Disciplines / & (No. of Top-Ranked Inst.)	Total No. of Publi-cation	Number of Citations			% of Citations		Average No. of Citations		
			Total	100/50	Remain-ing	100/50 Top Ranked	Remain-ing	Top 100/50	Remain-ing	Publi-cations
1757	Overall (100)	611693	5329034	3081761	2247273	57.83	42.17	30817.61	1356.23	8.71
506	Universities (100)	382638	3429638	2281793	1147845	66.53	33.47	22817.93	2827.2	8.96
229	Research (50)	454698	4121218	2450997	1670221	59.47	40.53	49019.94	9330.84	9.06
1489	Engineering (100)	275820	2412242	1507479	904763	62.49	37.51	15074.79	651.38	8.75
909	Management (100)	8304	90746	74658	16088	82.27	17.73	746.58	19.89	10.93
538	Pharmacy (101)	13410	124247	103308	20939	83.15	16.85	1022.85	47.92	9.27
1821	Colleges (100)	34940	286913	104064	182849	36.27	63.73	1040.64	106.25	8.21

Table 12: Citations to Publications of the 100 Top-Ranked Institutions as Compared to the Citations to Publications of the Remaining Eligible Institutions in Various Categories/ Subject Domains

- Publications (35)
- Citations (35)
- Patents (15)
- Research Projects (15)

Research and Professional Practice (0.30)

IPR and Patents: Published and Granted (IPR)

C. IPR and Patents: Patents Published & Granted (IPR): 15 marks

IPR = IPG + IPP

IPG = 10× f (PG)

- PG is the number of patents granted over the previous three years.

IPP = 5 × f (PP)

- PP: No. of patents published over the previous three years.
- **Primary Data: Third Party Sources**

No. of Eligible Inst.	Discipline / Categories	Number of Patents Granted			% of Patents Granted		Average No. of Patents Granted		
		Total	Top 100	Remaining Institution	% (100 Top Ranked)	% (Remaining Institutions)	100 Top Ranked	Remaining	All Eligible Insts.
1757	Overall (100)	8557	5133	3424	59.99	40.01	51.33	2.07	4.87
506	Universities (100)	4370	2844	1526	65.08	34.92	28.44	3.76	8.64
1489	Engineering (100)	7150	4624	2526	64.67	35.33	46.24	1.82	4.80
538	Pharmacy (101*)	757	622	135	82.17	17.83	6.16	0.31	1.41

Table 19: Patents Granted to the 100 Top-Ranked Institutions in Comparison to the Remaining Institutions in Various Categories and Subject Domains

- Publications (35)
- Citations (35)
- Patents (15)
- Research Projects (15)

Research and Professional Practice (0.30)



Footprint of Projects and Professional Practice (FPPP)

D. Footprint of Projects, Professional Practice and Executive Development Programs (FPPP): 15 marks

- **FPPP = FPR + FPC + EDP**
- **FPR = 5 × f(RF)**
- RF is the average annual research funding earnings (amount received in rupees) at institute level in previous three years.
- **FPC =5 × f(CF)**
- CF is the average annual consultancy amount (amount actually received in rupees) at institute level in previous three years.
- **EDP = 5 × f(EP)**
- EP = Average annual earnings from Full Time Executive Development Programs of a minimum duration of one year in previous three years.
- ***Primary Data: To be provided by the institution in prescribed format.***

Median SP	India Rankings 2023	India Rankings 2024	India Rankings 2025	% Increase / Decrease
Overall	1278900	1234445	960000	-24.94
Engineering	1131207	800000	750000	-33.7
Pharmacy	221334	174484	102689	-53.6

Table 23: Comparative Sponsored Research Funding: India Rankings from 2023 to 2025

- Publications (35)
- Citations (35)
- Patents (15)
- Research Projects (15)

Research and Professional Practice (0.30)



Publications & Citations in SDGs (PSDGs)

E. Combined Metric for Publication and Citation in SDGs (PSDGs): 10 marks

- $PSDGs = 5 \times f(PU_{SDG} / FRQ) + 5 \times f(CI_{SDG} / FRQ)$
- PU_{SDG} *is weighted number of publications as ascertained from suitable third party sources.*
- CI_{SDG} is total Citation Count over previous three years.
- FRQ *is the maximum of nominal number of faculty members as calculated on the basis of a required FSR of 1:15 or the available faculty in the institution.*
- ***Primary Data: Third Party Sources.***

Institutions	No. of Institutes	Total No. of Publications	Total No. of Citations Received	Highly-Cited Publications	% of Publications	% of Citations
IITs & IISc	19	99283	869237	27325	28.70	30.84
Deemed to be Universities	22	79914	678560	19150	23.10	20.62
State Public Universities	24	51231	456352	13349	14.81	16.86
Private Universities	9	36188	378267	10569	10.46	16.74
Central Universities	7	32156	300973	8329	9.29	9.13
Other CFTIs	10	25349	186459	4975	7.33	2.88
NITs	8	19810	183745	5256	5.73	1.95
Colleges	1	2059	28168	553	0.60	0.99
Grand Total	100	345990	3081761	89506	100	100

Table 22: Share of Publications, Citations and HCPs of the Top 100 Highly Productive Institutions in Overall Category

Graduation Outcome (0.20)

- Placement & Higher Studies (40)
- University Examinations (15)
- Median Salary (25)
- Ph.D Students (20)

Metric for University Examinations (GUE)

A. Metric for University Examinations (GUE): 60 Marks

- **GUE = 60 × min [(Ng/80), 1]**
- Ng is the percentage of Students (as a fraction of the approved intake), averaged over the previous three years, passing the respective university examinations in stipulated time for the program in which enrolled.
- ***Primary Data: To be provided in a prescribed format***

Metric for Number of Ph.D. Students Graduated (GPHD)

B. Metric for Number of Ph.D Students Graduated (GPHD): 40 Marks

- **GPHD = 40 × f(Nphd)**
- Nphd = Average number of Ph.D students graduated (awarded Ph.D) over the previous three years.
- ***Primary Data: Number of graduating Ph.D. Students as reflected in the approved Annual Report/Convocation Report to be provided in the prescribed format.***

Academic Year	No. of Full-time Ph.D. Students Graduated	% Increase
2021-22	33597	
2022-23	36598	8.93
2023-24	42634	16.49
Total	**112829**	

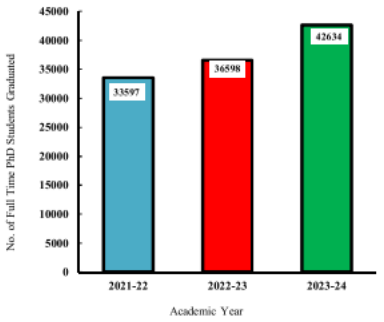


Table 24 and Fig. 22: Increase in Number of Ph.D. Graduated during Academic Years 2021-2022 to 2023-2024 in Overall Category

- Region Diversity (30)
- Women Diversity (30)
- Economically and Socially Challenged Students (20)
- Physically Challenged Students (20)

Outreach and Inclusivity (0.10)

Percentage of Students from Other States/Countries (Region Diversity RD)

A. Percentage of Students from Other States/ Countries (Region Diversity RD): 30 marks

RD = 25 × fraction of total students enrolled from other states + 5 × fraction of students enrolled from other countries

Primary Data: To be provided in the prescribed format.

Academic Year 23-24	No. of Students (all programs)	%
Within State	42,46,294	73.87
Outside State	14,46,176	25.16
Outside Country	55,521	0.97
Total No. of Students	57,47,991	

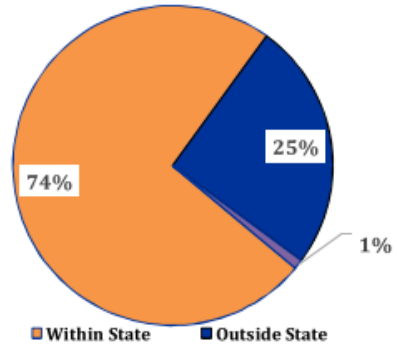


Table 25 and Fig. 23: Regional Diversity: No. and Percentage of Students from the Outside States and Countries in Overall Category during Academic Year 2023 - 24

- Region Diversity (30)
- Women Diversity (30)
- Economically and Socially Challenged Students (20)
- Physically Challenged Students (20)

Outreach and Inclusivity (0.10)

Percentage of Women (Women Diversity)

B. Percentage of Women (Women Diversity WD): 30 marks

- $WD = 15 \times (N_{WS}/50) + 15 \times (N_{WF}/20)$
- N_{WS} are the percentage of Women students.
- N_{WF} are the percentage of Women Faculty including women members in senior administrative positions, such as Heads of Departments, Deans or Institute Heads.
- Expectation: 50% women students and 20% women faculty.
- ***Primary Data: To be provided in the prescribed format.***

Gender	No. of Students	%
Male	31,73,087	55.20
Female	25,74,904	44.80
Total	57,47,991	

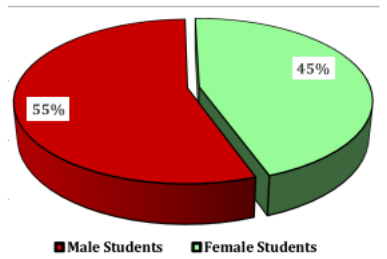


Table 26 and Fig. 24: Gender Diversity amongst Students: Male vs Female Enrolment in Overall Category in Academic Year 2023 – 24

Gender of Faculty	Number of Faculty	%
Male	1,97,143	56.87
Female	1,49,528	43.13
Total No. of Faculty	3,46,671	

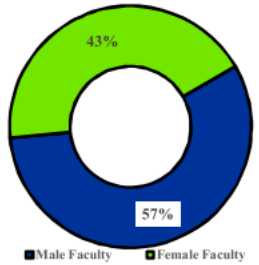


Table 27 and Fig. 25: Gender Diversity amongst Faculty: Male vs Female Faculty in Overall Category in the Academic Year 2023 – 24

- Region Diversity (30)
- Women Diversity (30)
- Economically and Socially Challenged Students (20)
- Physically Challenged Students (20)

Outreach and Inclusivity (0.10)



Economically and Socially Challenged Students (ESCS)

C. Economically and Socially Challenged Students (ESCS) : 20 marks

- **ESCS $= 20 \times f(N_{esc})$**
- N_{esc} is the percentage of UG or *PG students being provided full tuition fee rembursement by the institution to pursue their degree programs.
- ***Primary Data: To be provided by the institution in a prescribed format.***

Facilities for Physically Challenged Students (PCS)

D. Facilities for Physically Challenged Students (PCS): 20 marks

- **PCS = 20 marks, if the Institute provides full facilities for physically challenged students, as outlined.**

  Else, in proportion to facilities.

- Basis: Verifiable Responses to Questions.

- ***Primary Data: To be provided in a prescribed format.***

Perception (0.10)

- Peer Perception: Academic Peers and Employers (100)

Academic Peers and Employers (PR)

A. Peer Perception: Employers & Academic Peer (PR): 100 marks

- This is to be done through a survey conducted over a large category of Employers, Professionals from Reputed Organizations and a large category of academics to ascertain their preference for graduates of different institutions.
- Comprehensive list will be prepared taking into account various sectors, regions, etc.
- Lists to be updated periodically.

For State Public Universities, the Faculty Student Ratio (FSR) is considered based on 1:20.
* For Universities and State Public Universities, in the Perception parameter, 70% weight is given to Peer Perception and 30% to Accreditation.

6.3.2. Publications, Citations and Highly Cited Publications (HCP): Web of Science (WoS) and Scopus

Two sets of citation databases were used as sources for retrieving data on the number of publications, citations, and highly cited publications for the applicant institutions. These citation databases comprise of: i) Science Citation Index Expanded (SCI-Expanded), Social Sciences Citation Index (SSCI), Arts & Humanities Citation Index (A&HCI), Conference Proceedings Citation Index - Science (CPCI-S), Conference Proceedings Citation Index - Social Sciences & Humanities (CPCI-SSH), Book Citation Index– Science (BKCI-S), Book Citation Index– Social Sciences & Humanities (BKCI-SSH), Emerging Sources Citation Index (ESCI) and Current Chemical Reactions (CCR-Expanded) hosted on the Web of Science platform; and ii) Scopus. These sources of publications and citations cover all disciplines comprehensively.

These databases were searched to determine the quantitative productivity of all eligible applicant institutions that registered themselves for ranking. The search included number of research articles published and citations received by them in a span of three calendar years, i.e. 2021, 2022 and 2023. A common time window was used to obtain this data covering a short span of two weeks for all institutions to ensure fairness, i.e. between February 21, 2025 to March 10, 2025 from Web of Science and Scopus. The data on highly cited publications (HCP) was retrieved between 15th to 31st March 2025 from Web of Science and Scopus.

6.3.2.1 Search Strategy for Retrieving Research Publications, Citations and Highly Cited Publications from Web of Science and Scopus

All permutations, combinations, and changes in the names of institutions were used while searching for articles published by faculty and researchers in the databases mentioned above. Since searches were conducted using names of institutions, articles that did not have institutional affiliations of their faculty and researchers were not retrieved.

Several universities host other research institutions within their physical premises. Care was taken to ensure that credit for publications and citations are given to the concerned institutions. Manual checking of retrieved data was done in cases i) where two institutions with same (or similar) names, ii) institutes that share the same physical premises; and iii) multiple institutes having the same name in the same city, for example Government Colleges, DAV Colleges, etc.

Some private universities have several constituent colleges and institutions (either in the same city or in different cities) that are their integral part. Information was sought from the applicant institutes and universities about such constituent entities. Publications and citations received by such constituent entities were credited to the applicant institution after due verification.

A number of variations in the names of universities and institutions, their physical locations and their spellings were discovered during the searches in the databases. Every care was taken to be accurate on this count. Moreover, the data on highly cited publications was retrieved from Web of Science and data on Field-weighted Citations was obtained from Scopus (Elsevier Science). Data on patents granted and published for each institutions for last three years, i.e. 2021, 2022 and 2023, was retrieved from Derwent Innovation.

6.5.2. Communication with Nodal Officers

Each institution was asked to nominate one of their senior functionaries as a nodal officer for dealing with NIRF matters. These nodal officers were contacted to clear doubts or to attend to the feedback and anomalies pointed out by the expert committees. For increased transparency, an advisory was sent to each institution to upload this data on their own website for dissemination to the public. For all the top-ranked institutions, the latest version of the corrected data based on further inputs from the institutions was made visible on the NIRF portal.

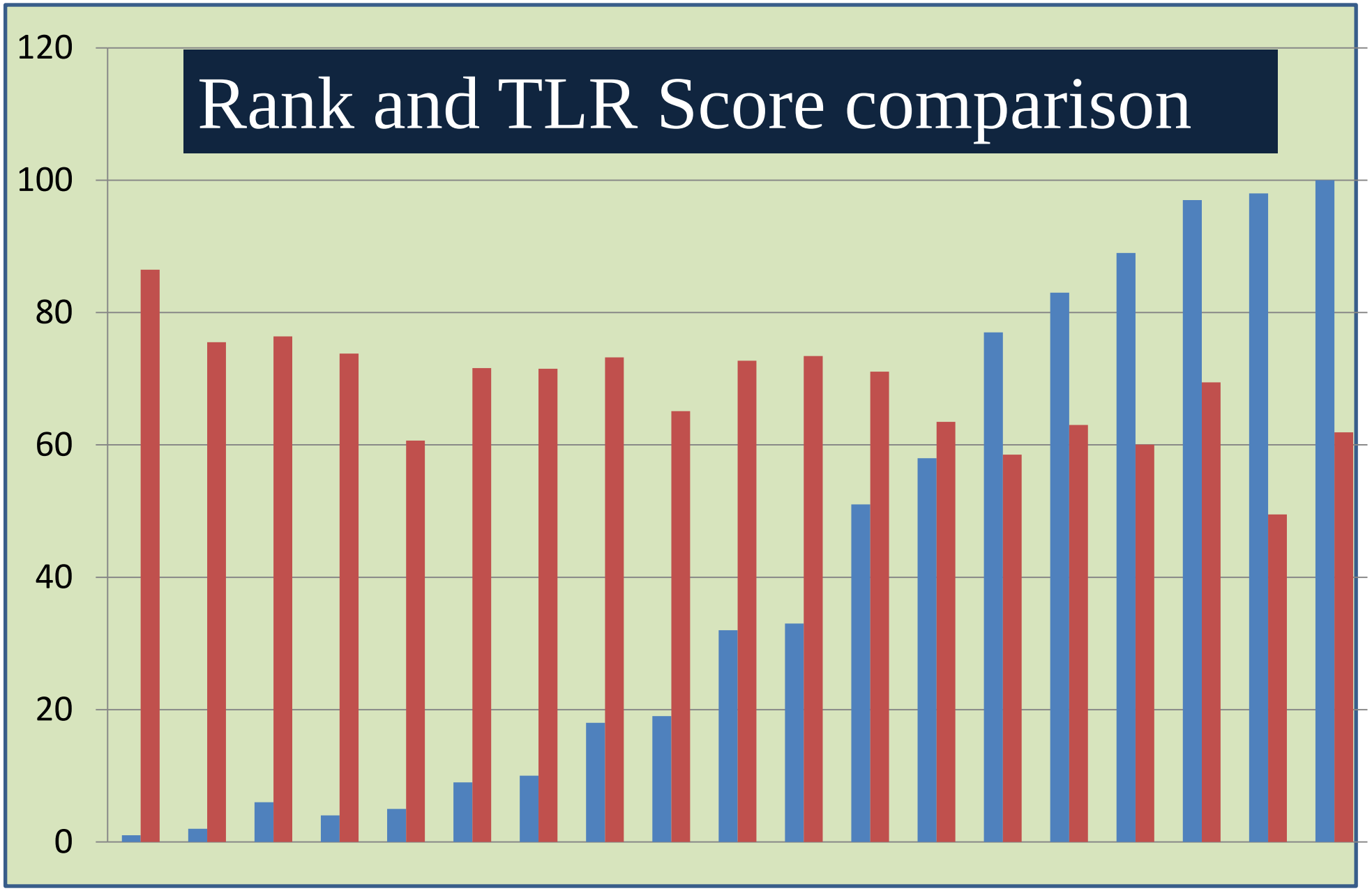
While significant efforts were made to authenticate the data, the final responsibility for the accuracy of the submitted data lies with the concerned institutions.

6.5.3. Verification of Data on Publications, Citations and Highly Cited Publications

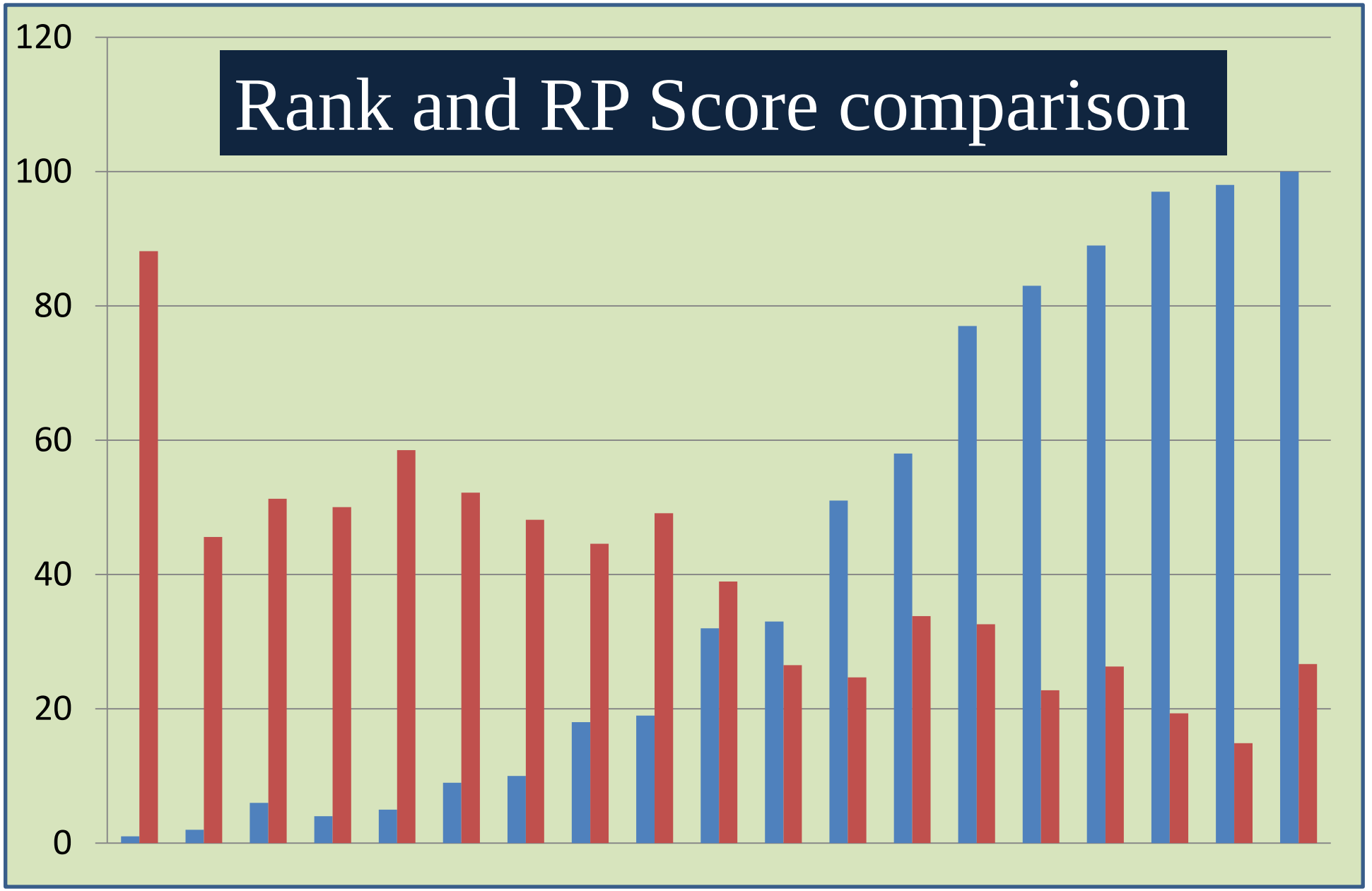
The data on publications, citations and highly cited publications was shared with each applicant institution between 22nd May and 31st May 2025. Institutions were informed that the data was captured between 21st February 2025 and 10th March 2025 from Web of Science and Scopus. The data on highly cited publications (HCP) was retrieved between 15th and 31st March 2025 from Web of Science and Scopus.

Analysis of 2025 Ranking – Future Planning

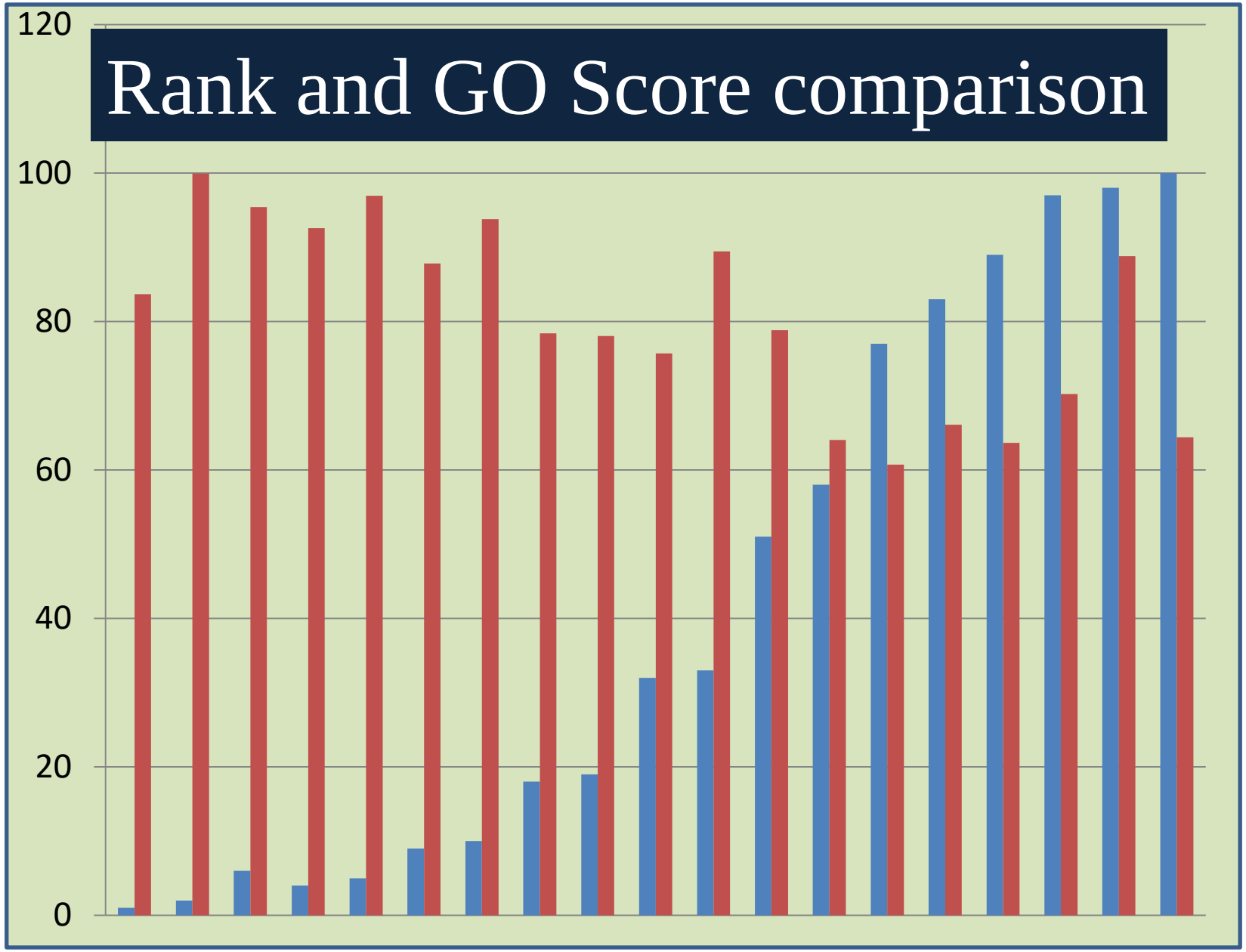
Overall	Univ	Name	TLR (30)						RP (30)					GO (20)			OI (10)						PR (10)	score	
			SS	FSR	FQE	FRU	OE+MIR	TLR	PU	QP	IPR	FFPP	RP	GUE	GPHD	GO	RD	WD	ESCS	PCS	OI	PR	PR	Overall	Univ
			20	25	20	20	15	100	35	35	15	15	100	60	40	100	30	30	20	20	100	100	100	100	100
1		IIT M	17	23.15	16.69	20	13.75	90.59	32.94	30.21	14	10.88	88.03	60	27.01	87.01	21.11	14.57	7.66	20	63.34	100		87.31	
2	1	IISc	12.5	25	18.69	19.78	10.5	86.47	35	30.87	13	9.28	88.15	57.79	25.9	83.69	23.61	13.16	3.52	20	60.29	98.41		85	
9	2	JNU	16.69	25	16.89	11.69	5.25	75.52	21.45	20.67	2.5	0.96	45.58	60	39.93	99.93	24.44	27.22	7.16	20	78.82	54.13	67.89	69.62	71
10	6	BHU	19.36	21.77	17.42	11.37	6.5	76.42	21.4	24.14	2.35	3.39	51.28	60	35.42	95.42	12.68	29.21	4.07	20	65.96	47.63	33.34	68.71	67.28
13	4	JMI	15.99	25	15.84	10.98	6	73.81	21.53	23.06	2.5	2.94	50.03	60	32.56	92.56	23.37	30	10.46	20	83.83	29.47	50.63	66.99	69.1
15	5	UD	18.45	16.02	13.01	8.79	4.38	60.65	27.38	27.62	2	1.52	58.52	56.94	40	96.94	20.36	28.53	0.97	20	69.86	40.55	52.28	66.19	67.38
18	9	JU	17.46	24.41	18.24	6.38	5.13	71.62	22.61	22.86	4.5	2.22	52.19	57.67	30.14	87.81	2.63	23.73	5.98	20	52.34	44.1		64.34	
19	10	AMU	18.4	23.25	16.73	9.74	3.38	71.5	20.67	23.56	2.35	1.56	48.14	60	33.79	93.79	10.48	26.85	7.25	20	64.58	26.77		63.76	
26	18	UoH	13	25	18.58	11.29	5.38	73.25	21.19	20.02	2	1.38	44.59	55.54	22.88	78.42	16.71	26.3	0	20	63.01	29.68		60.32	
32	19	CU	17.85	24.13	14.43	4.32	4.38	65.11	16.13	20.16	11	1.84	49.13	60	18.05	78.05	22.92	30	1.33	20	74.25	22.48		59.55	
50	32	CUSAT	11.97	25	18.92	12.1	4.75	72.74	18.67	15.78	2.25	2.25	38.95	60	15.69	75.69	4.76	30	4.19	20	58.95	7.45		55.38	
52	33	GU	15.87	25	18.93	8.95	4.69	73.44	11.68	12.46	1	1.35	26.49	60	29.46	89.46	5.3	30	8.9	20	64.2	9.78		55.27	
87	51	UoJ	12.5	25	18.94	10.52	4.13	71.09	10.52	13.42	0	0.73	24.67	60	18.84	78.84	0.48	30	2.09	20	52.57	3.52		50.11	
98	58	MU-J	14.76	22.96	14.58	5.18	6	63.48	12.44	14.01	7	0.36	33.81	60	4.04	64.04	18.89	27.55	0.31	20	66.75	7.11	20.98	49.38	
	77	CUP	8.87	21.72	16.63	6.3	5	58.52	14.98	16.56	0.75	0.29	32.58	54.49	6.23	60.72	19.53	26.87	0	20	66.4		34.05		49.53
	83	CUT	7.84	25	19.04	6.5	4.63	63.01	9.09	12.18	1.25	0.25	22.77	59.77	6.32	66.09	12.38	28.85	3.69	20	64.92		36.94		49.13
	89	CUR	8.94	21.91	17.46	7.75	4	60.06	12.08	12.99	0.75	0.46	26.28	56.47	7.17	63.64	11.79	26.25	1.98	20	60.02		38.38		48.47
	97	AU	13.46	25	18.41	7.83	4.75	69.45	7.99	10.35	0.5	0.5	19.34	54.83	15.41	70.24	3.97	30	1.96	20	55.93		10		47.28
	98	UoL	15.54	14.34	11.22	3.76	4.63	49.49	4.94	8.64	0.75	0.54	14.87	60	28.79	88.79	11.79	28.93	4.18	20	64.9		36.39		47.26
	100	IIIT	9.5	21.39	14.08	8.56	8.38	61.91	12.46	12.08	1.25	0.88	26.67	60	4.4	64.4	12.88	19.09	0.99	20	52.96		23.24		47.07



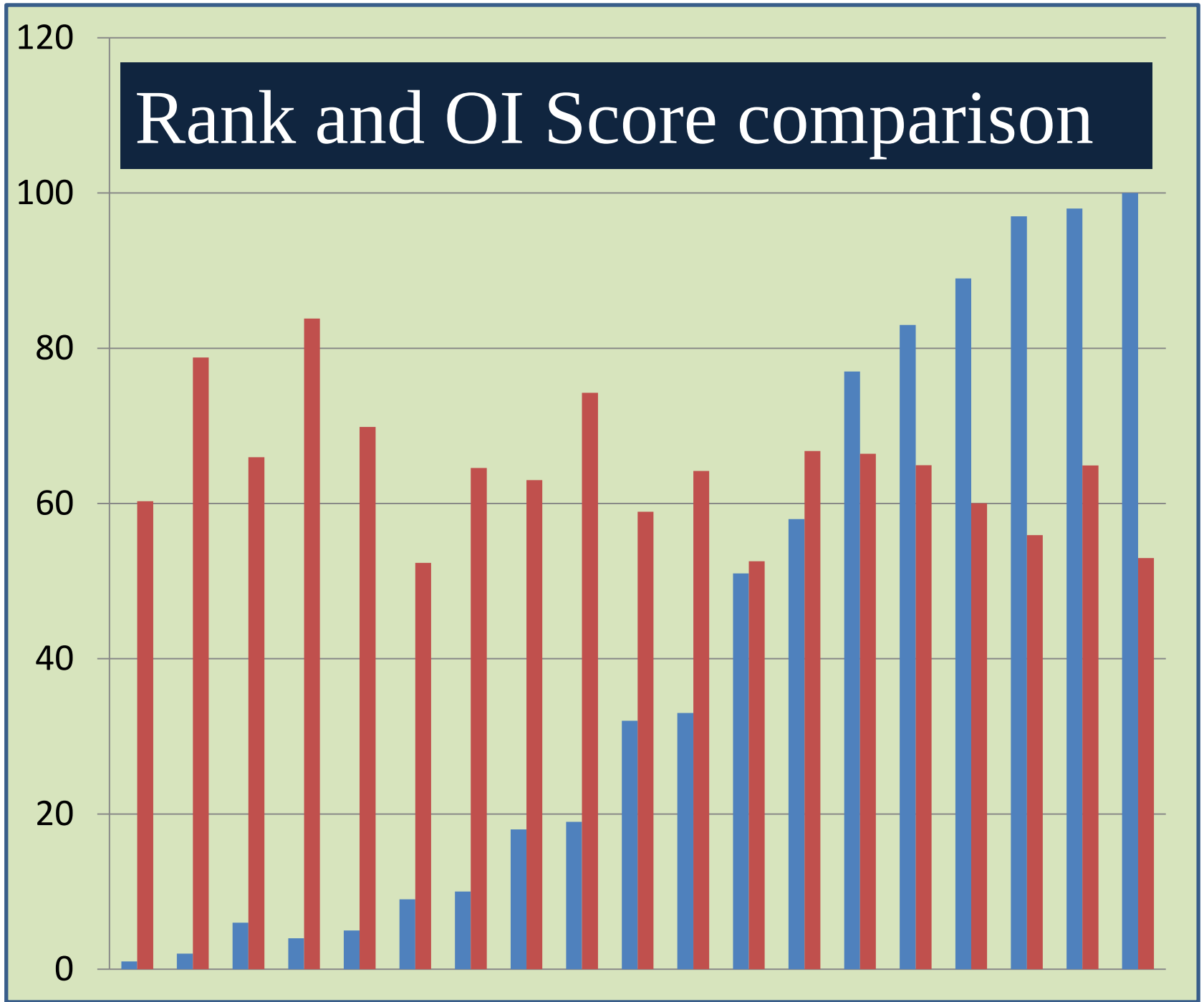
S.No.	Rank	Name
1	1	IISc
2	2	JNU
3	6	BHU
4	4	JMI
5	5	UD
6	9	JU
7	10	AMU
8	18	UoH
9	19	CU
10	32	CUSAT
11	33	GU
12	51	UoJ
13	58	MU-J
14	77	CUP
15	83	CUT
16	89	CUR
17	97	AU
18	98	UoL
19	100	IIIT



S.No.	Rank	Name
1	1	IISc
2	2	JNU
3	6	BHU
4	4	JMI
5	5	UD
6	9	JU
7	10	AMU
8	18	UoH
9	19	CU
10	32	CUSAT
11	33	GU
12	51	UoJ
13	58	MU-J
14	77	CUP
15	83	CUT
16	89	CUR
17	97	AU
18	98	UoL
19	100	IIIT



S.No.	Rank	Name
1	1	IISc
2	2	JNU
3	6	BHU
4	4	JMI
5	5	UD
6	9	JU
7	10	AMU
8	18	UoH
9	19	CU
10	32	CUSAT
11	33	GU
12	51	UoJ
13	58	MU-J
14	77	CUP
15	83	CUT
16	89	CUR
17	97	AU
18	98	UoL
19	100	IIIT

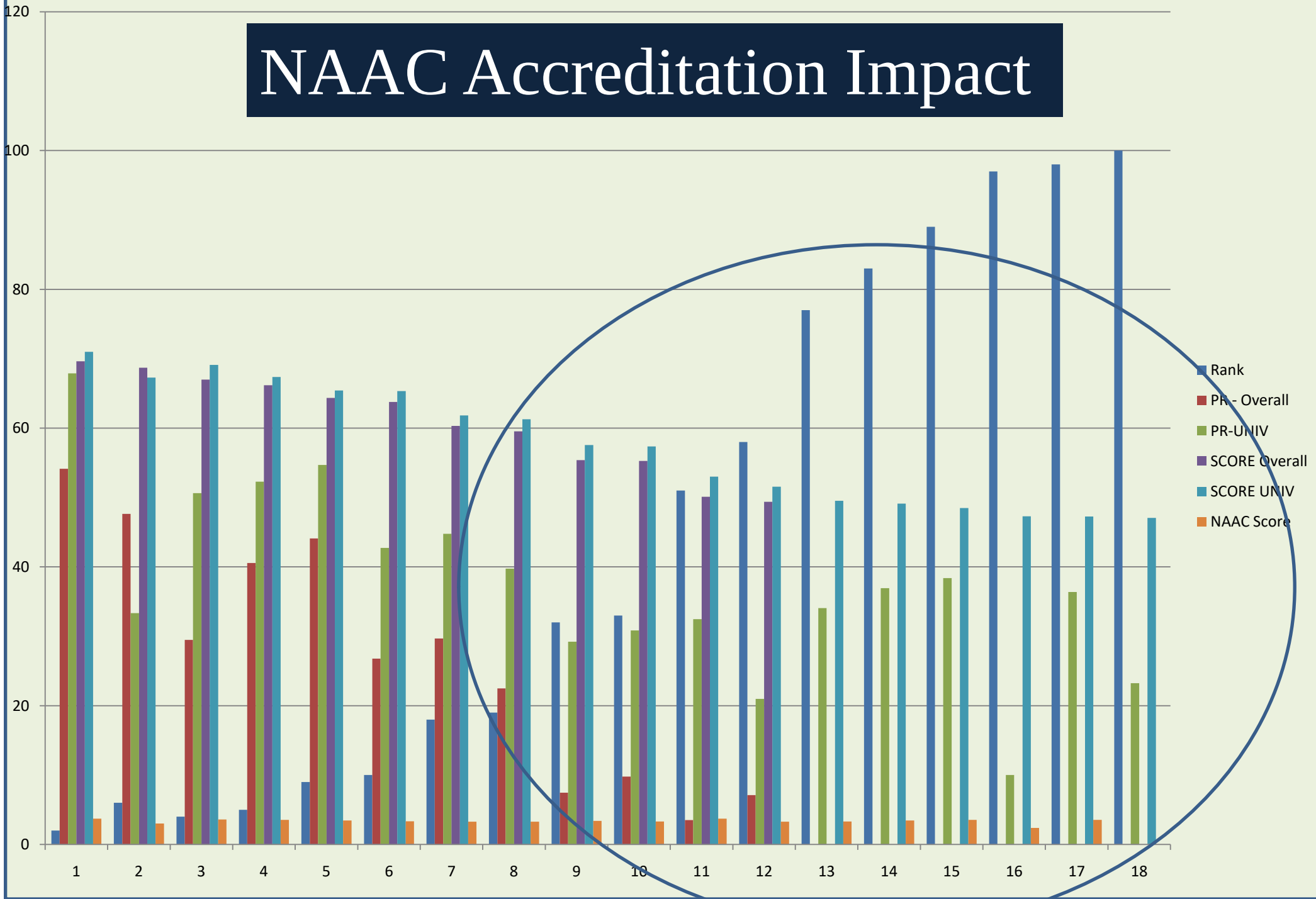


S.No.	Rank	Name
1	1	IISc
2	2	JNU
3	6	BHU
4	4	JMI
5	5	UD
6	9	JU
7	10	AMU
8	18	UoH
9	19	CU
10	32	CUSAT
11	33	GU
12	51	UoJ
13	58	MU-J
14	77	CUP
15	83	CUT
16	89	CUR
17	97	AU
18	98	UoL
19	100	IIIT

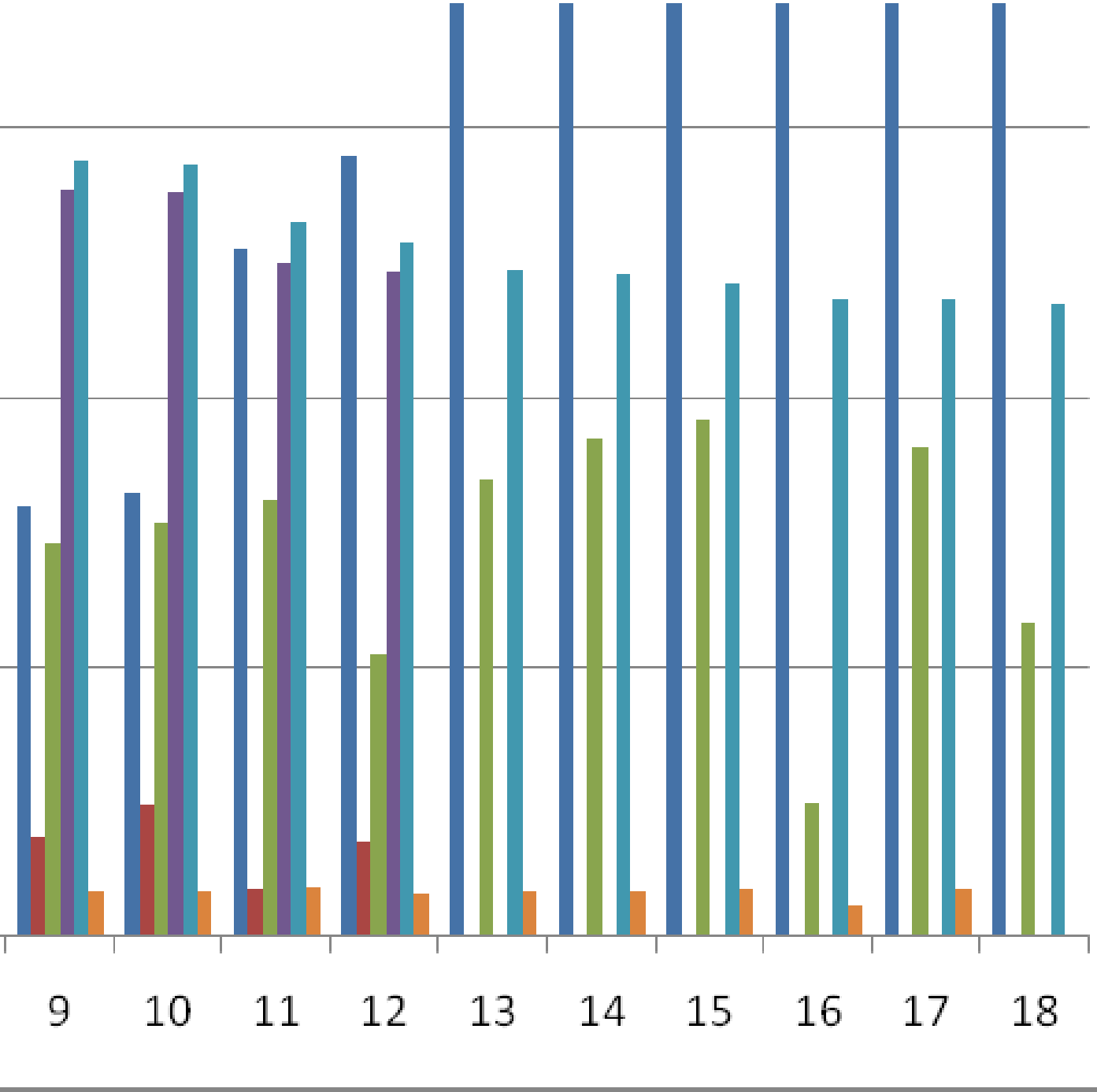
Peer Perception – Overall and University Ranking

S.No.	Rank	Name	PR - Overall	PR-UNIV	SCORE Overall	SCORE UNIV	NAAC Grade	NAAC Score
1	2	JNU	54.13	67.89	69.62	71	A++	3.71
2	6	BHU	47.63	33.34	68.71	67.28	A	3.01
3	4	JMI	29.47	50.63	66.99	69.1	A++	3.61
4	5	UD	40.55	52.28	66.19	67.38	A++	3.55
5	9	JU	44.1	54.7	64.34	65.42	A+	3.46
6	10	AMU	26.77	42.74	63.76	65.35	A+	3.35
7	18	UoH	29.68	44.77	60.32	61.83	A+	3.28
8	19	CU	22.48	39.74	59.55	61.27	A+	3.28
9	32	CUSAT	7.45	29.22	55.38	57.55	A+	3.39
10	33	GU	9.78	30.84	55.27	57.37	A+	3.32
11	51	UoJ	3.52	32.46	50.11	53.01	A++	3.72
12	58	MU-J	7.11	20.98	49.38	51.57	A+	3.28
13	77	CUP		34.05		49.53	A+	3.3
14	83	CUT		36.94		49.13	A+	3.44
15	89	CUR		38.38		48.47	A++	3.54
16	97	AU		10		47.28	B	2.39
17	98	UoL		36.39		47.26	A++	3.55
18	100	IIIT		23.24		47.07	A	

NAAC Accreditation Impact



S.No.	Rank	Name
1	1	IISc
2	2	JNU
3	6	BHU
4	4	JMI
5	5	UD
6	9	JU
7	10	AMU
8	18	UoH
9	19	CU
10	32	CUSAT
11	33	GU
12	51	UoJ
13	58	MU-J
14	77	CUP
15	83	CUT
16	89	CUR
17	97	AU
18	98	UoL
19	100	IIIT



NAAC Accreditation Impact

S.No.	Rank	Name	PR Overall	PR Univ	Score Overall	Score Univ	NAAC Grade	NAAC Score
9	32	CUSAT	7.45	29.22	55.38	57.55	A+	3.39
10	33	GU	9.78	30.84	55.27	57.37	A+	3.32
11	51	UoJ	3.52	32.46	50.11	53.01	A++	3.72
12	58	MU-J	7.11	20.98	49.38	51.57	A+	3.28
13	77	CUP		34.05		49.53	A+	3.3
14	83	CUT		36.94		49.13	A+	3.44
15	89	CUR		38.38		48.47	A++	3.54
16	97	AU		10		47.28	B	2.39
17	98	UoL		36.39		47.26	A++	3.55
18	100	IIIT		23.24		47.07	A	

NAAC Accreditation

ASSESSMENT & ACCREDITATION

Education plays a vital role in the development of any nation. Therefore, there is a premium on both quantity (increased access) and quality (relevance and excellence of academic programmes offered) of higher education. The NAAC has been set up to facilitate the volunteering institutions to assess their performance vis-a-vis set parameters through introspection and a process that provides space for participation of the institution.

ELIGIBILITY CRITERIA

Higher Education Institutions (HEIs), with a record of at least two batches of students graduated, or been in existence for six years, whichever is earlier, are eligible to apply for the process of Assessment and Accreditation (A&A) of NAAC, and fulfil the other conditions or are covered by the other provisions, if any, mentioned below:

1. Universities (Central / State / Private / Deemed-to-be) and Institutions of National Importance

2. Autonomous colleges /Constituent Colleges / Affiliated Colleges (affiliated to universities recognised by UGC as an affiliating University)

3. Accredited HEIs applying for Reassessment or Subsequent Cycles (Cycle 2, Cycle 3, Cycle 4) of Accreditation

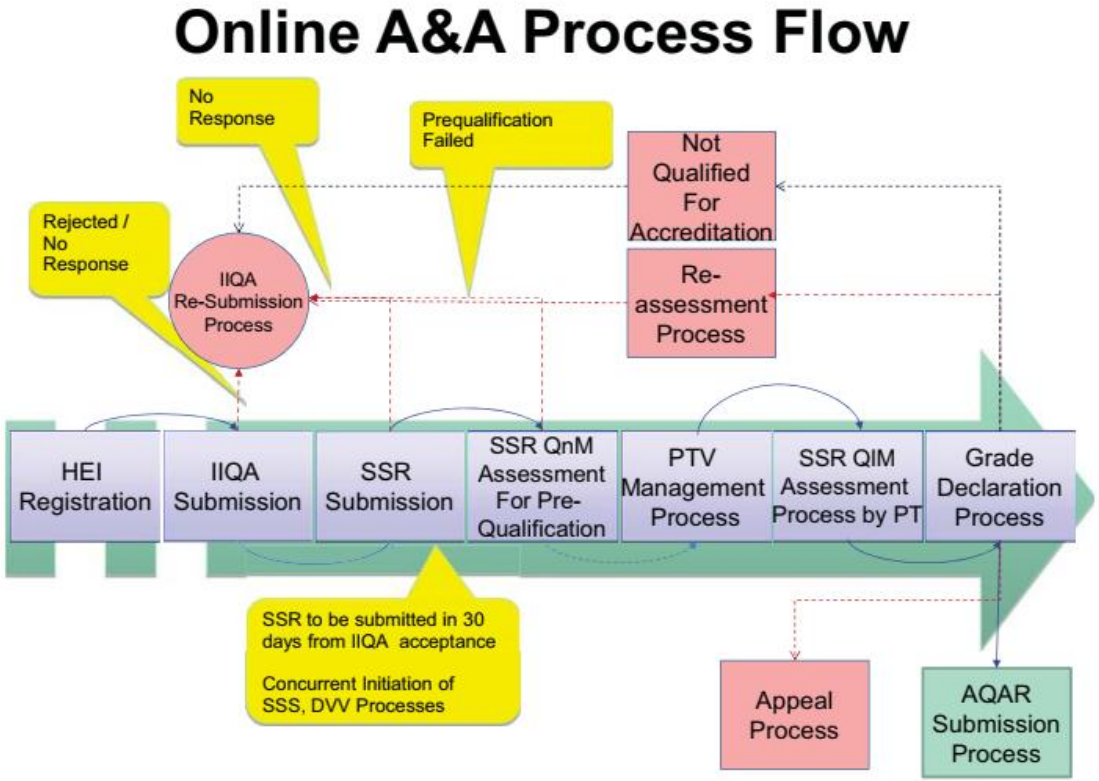
The criterion-wise differential weightages for the three types of HEIs are:

Curricular Aspects	150 (U)	150 (Au)	100 (Aff UG)	100 (Aff PG)
Teaching-learning & Evaluation	200 (U)	300 (Au)	350 (Aff UG)	350 (Aff PG)
Research, Innovations & Extension	250 (U)	150 (Au)	110 (Aff UG)	120 (Aff PG)
Infrastructure & Learning Resources	100 (U)	100 (Au)	100 (Aff UG)	100 (Aff PG)
Student Support & Progression	100 (U)	100 (Au)	140 (Aff UG)	130 (Aff PG)
Governance, Leadership & Management	100 (U)	100 (Au)	100 (Aff UG)	100 (Aff PG)
Institutional Values & Best Practices	100 (U)	100 (Au)	100 (Aff UG)	100 (Aff PG)

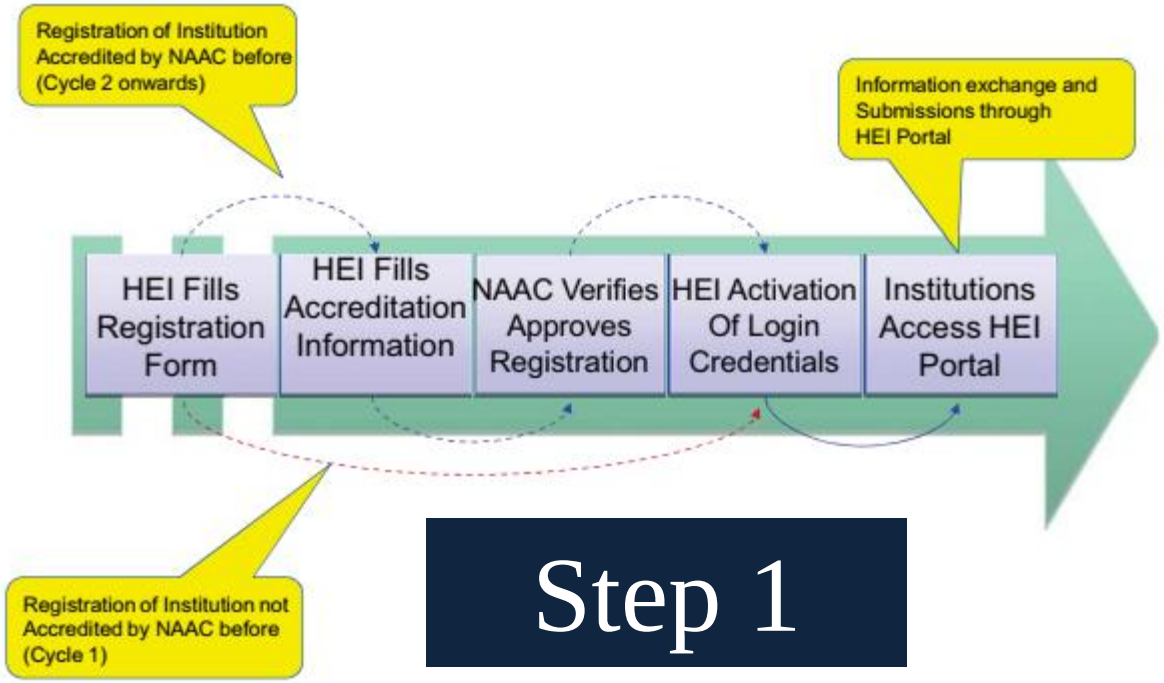
Key Indicators

Under each Criterion a few Key Indicators are identified. These Key Indicators (KIs) are further delineated as Metrics which actually elicit responses from the HEIs.

Metrics and Work flow

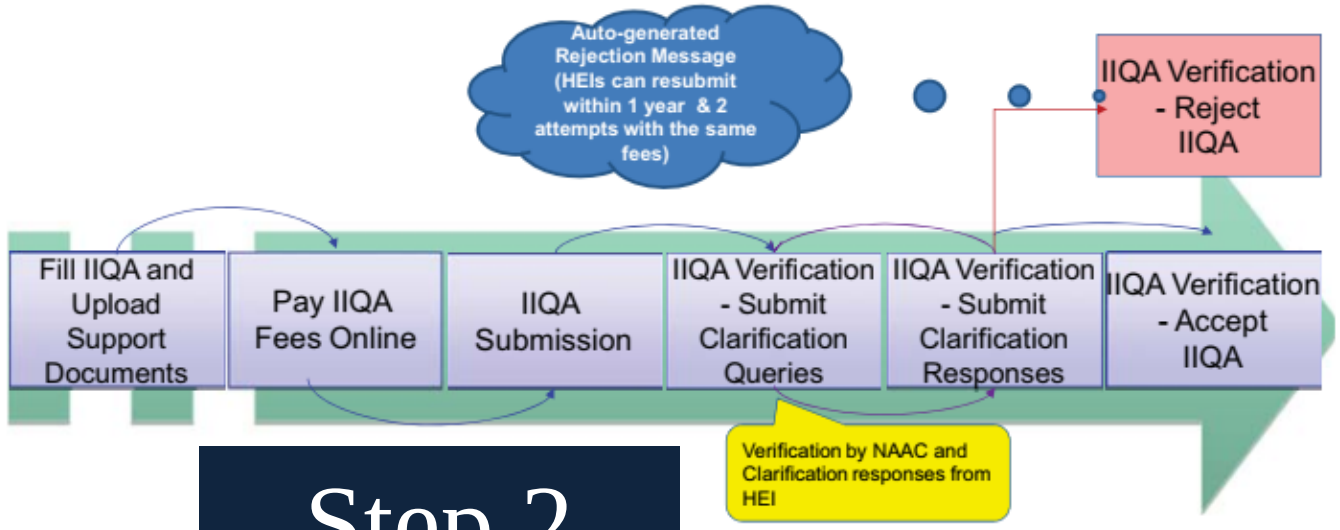


HEI Registration Process



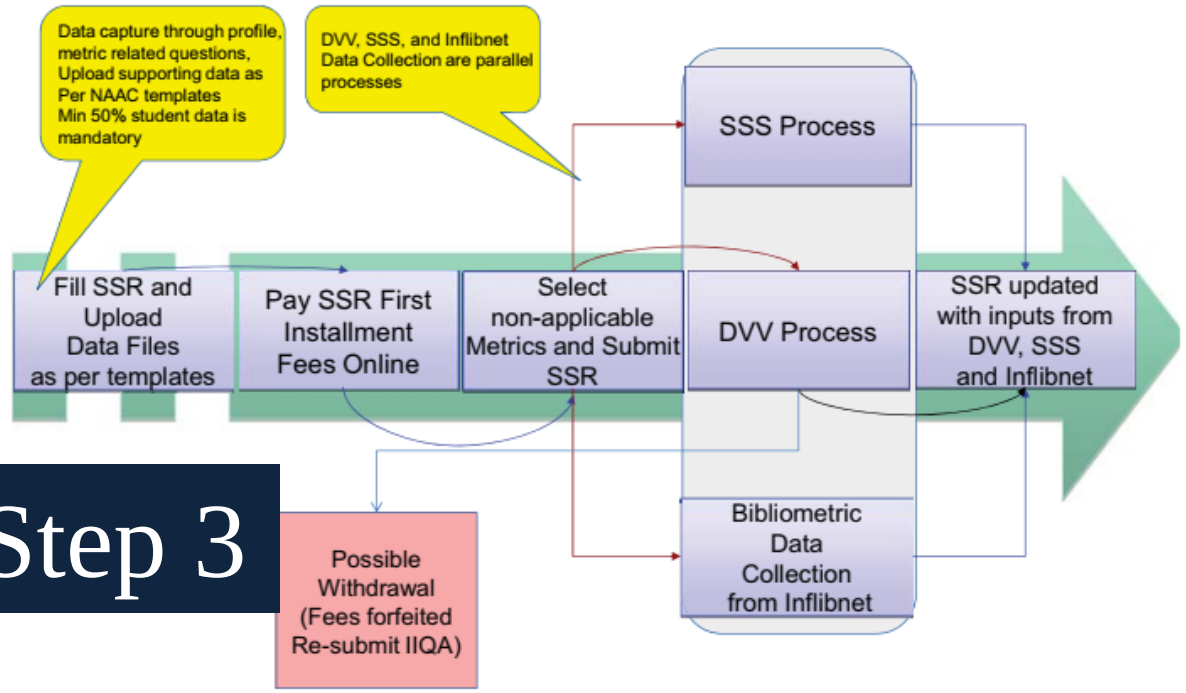
Step 1

IIQA Submission Process



Step 2

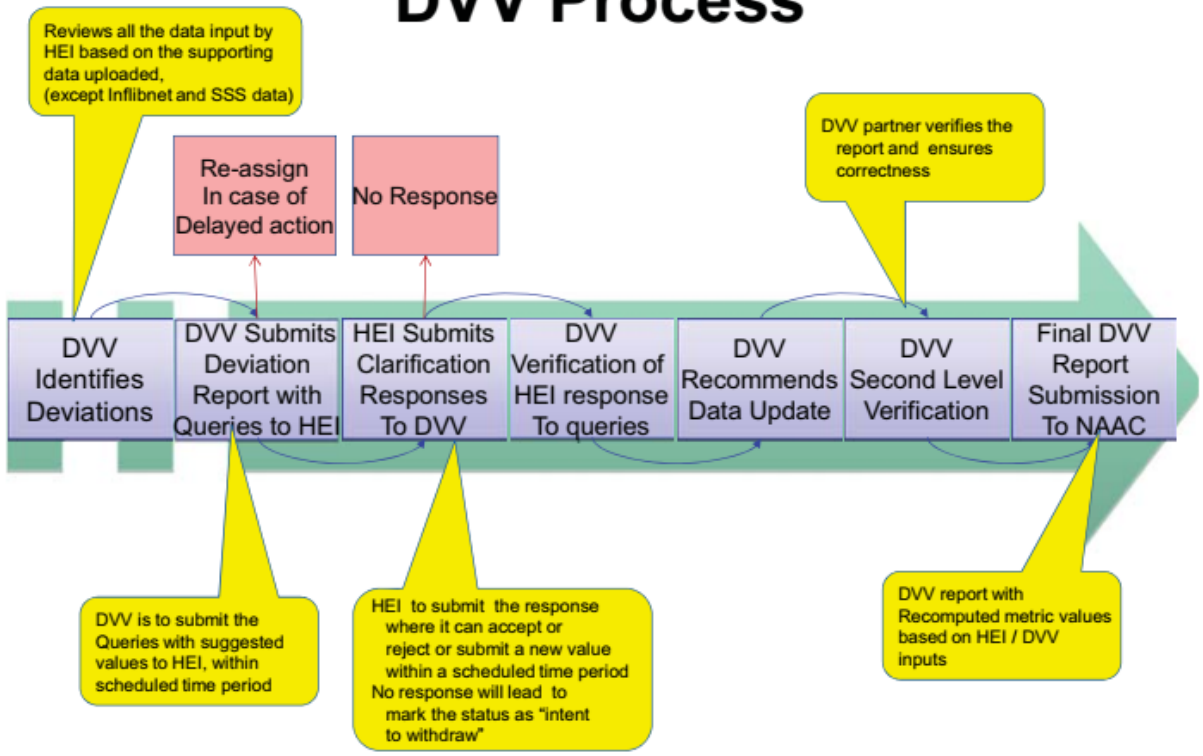
SSR Submission Process



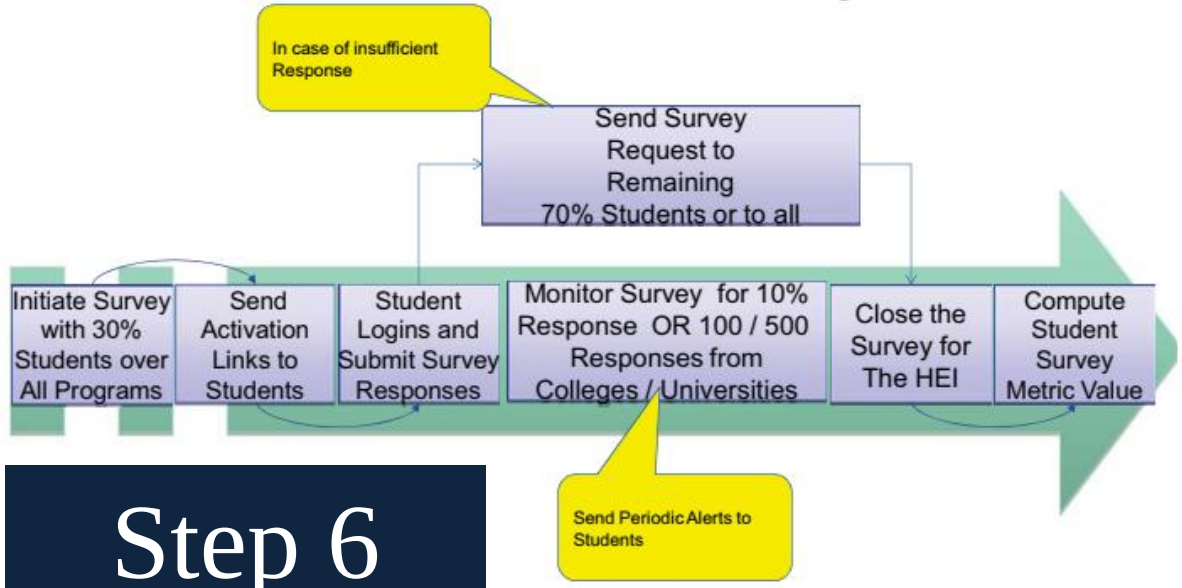
Step 3

Step 4

DVV Process

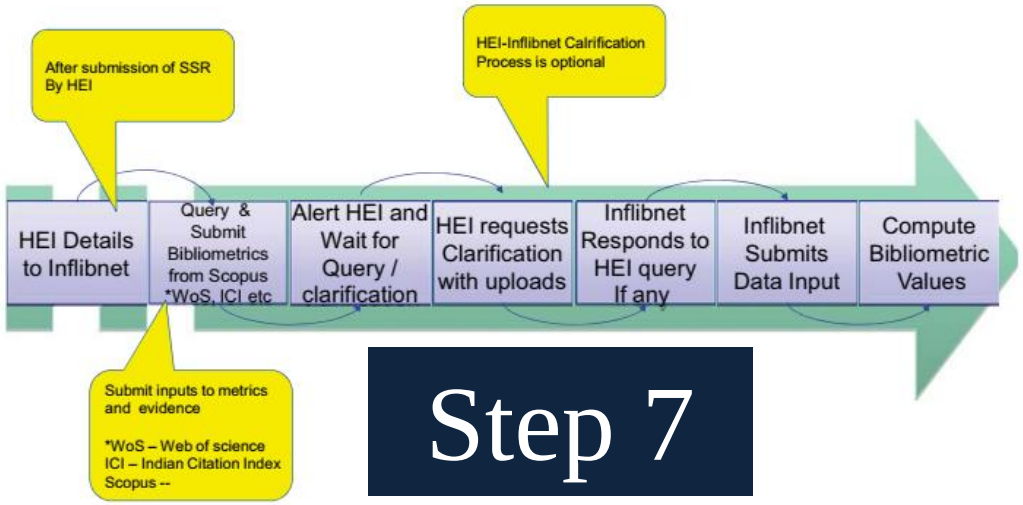


Student Satisfaction Survey Process



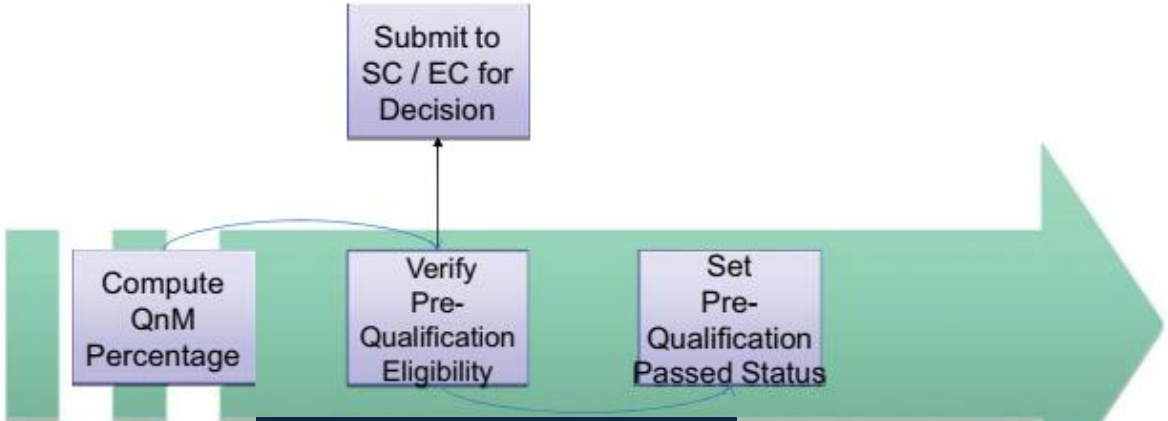
Step 6

Inflibnet Bibliometric Data Feed



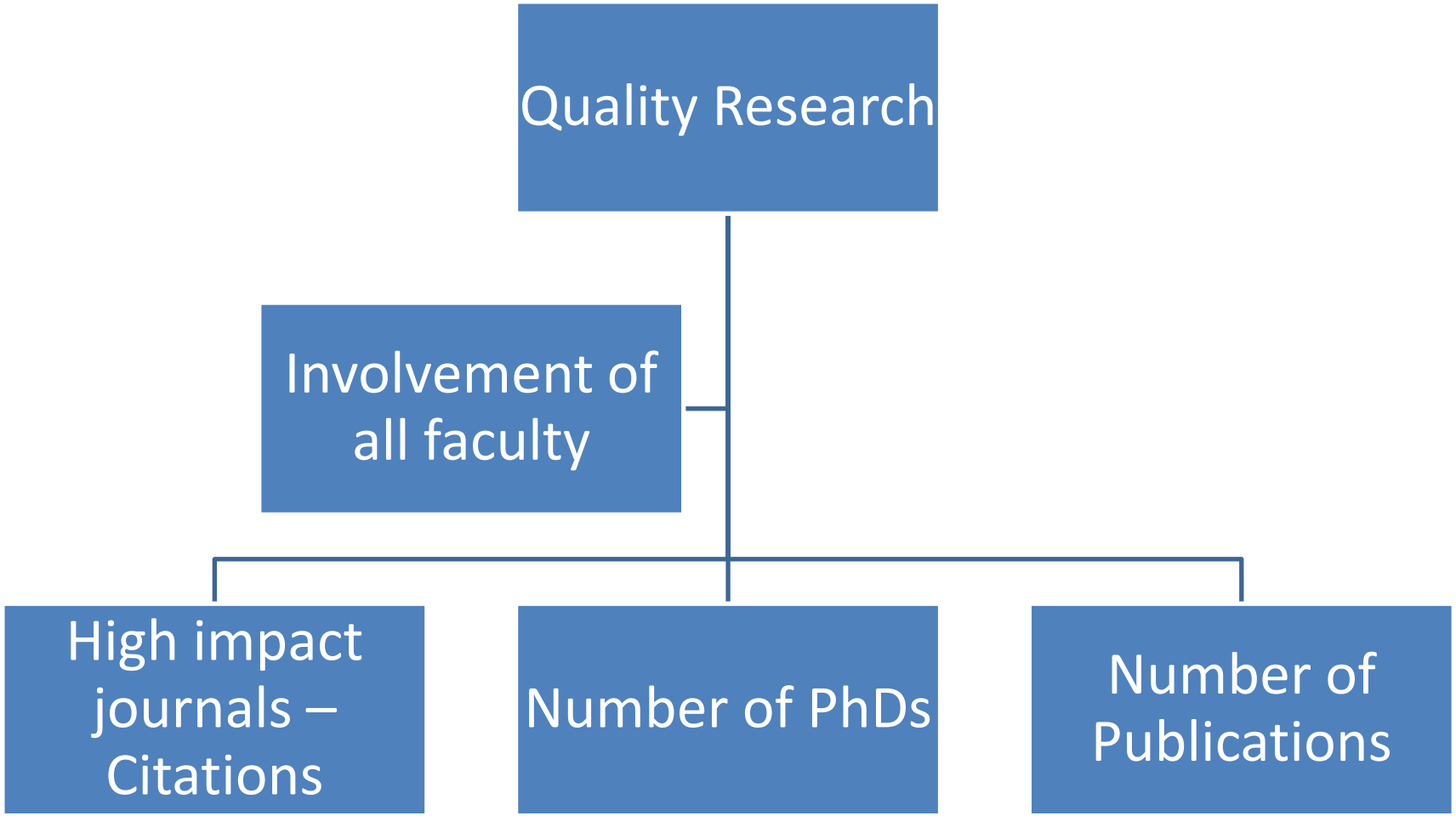
Step 7

SSR QnM Evaluation for Pre-Qualification

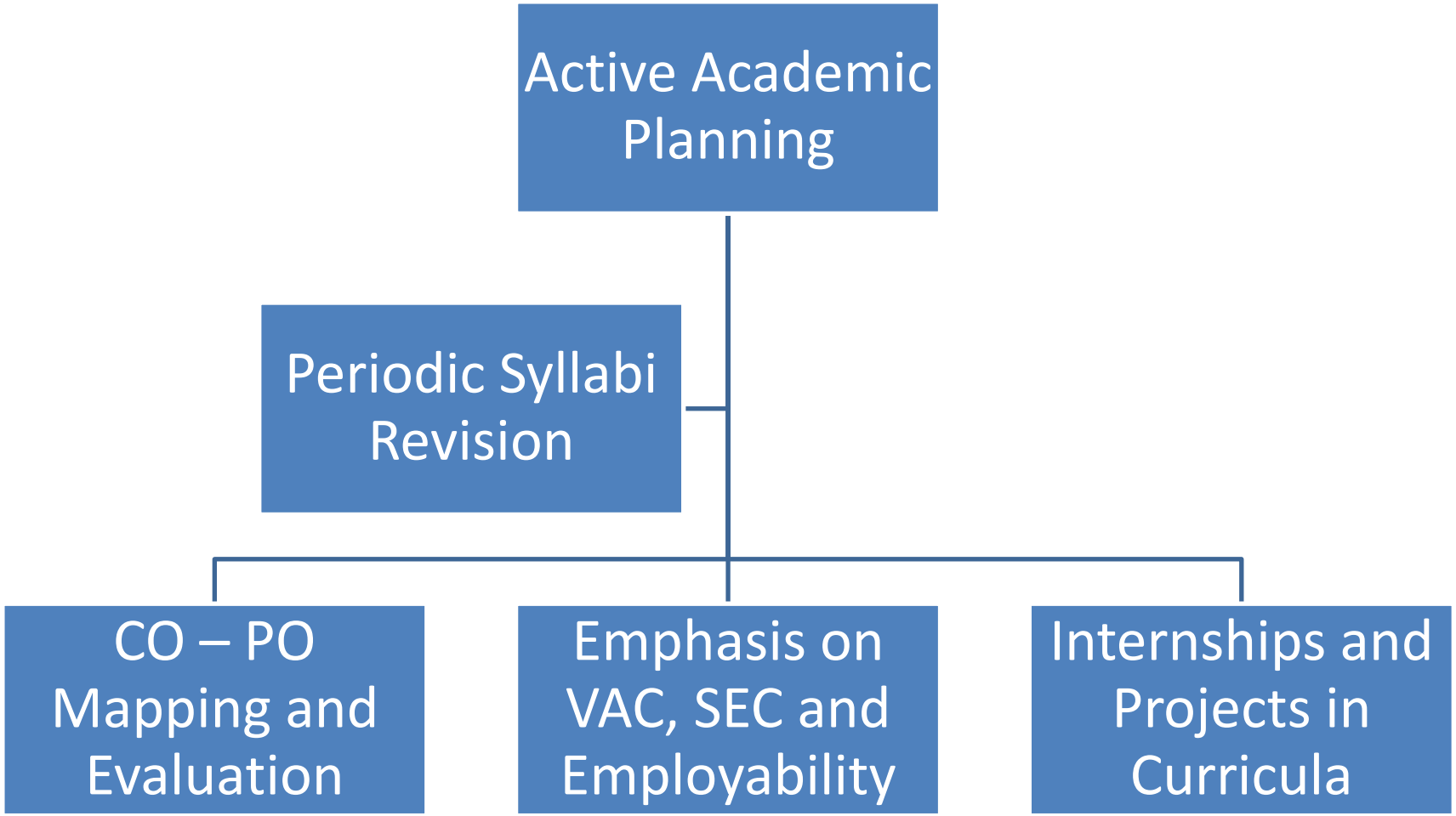


Step 8

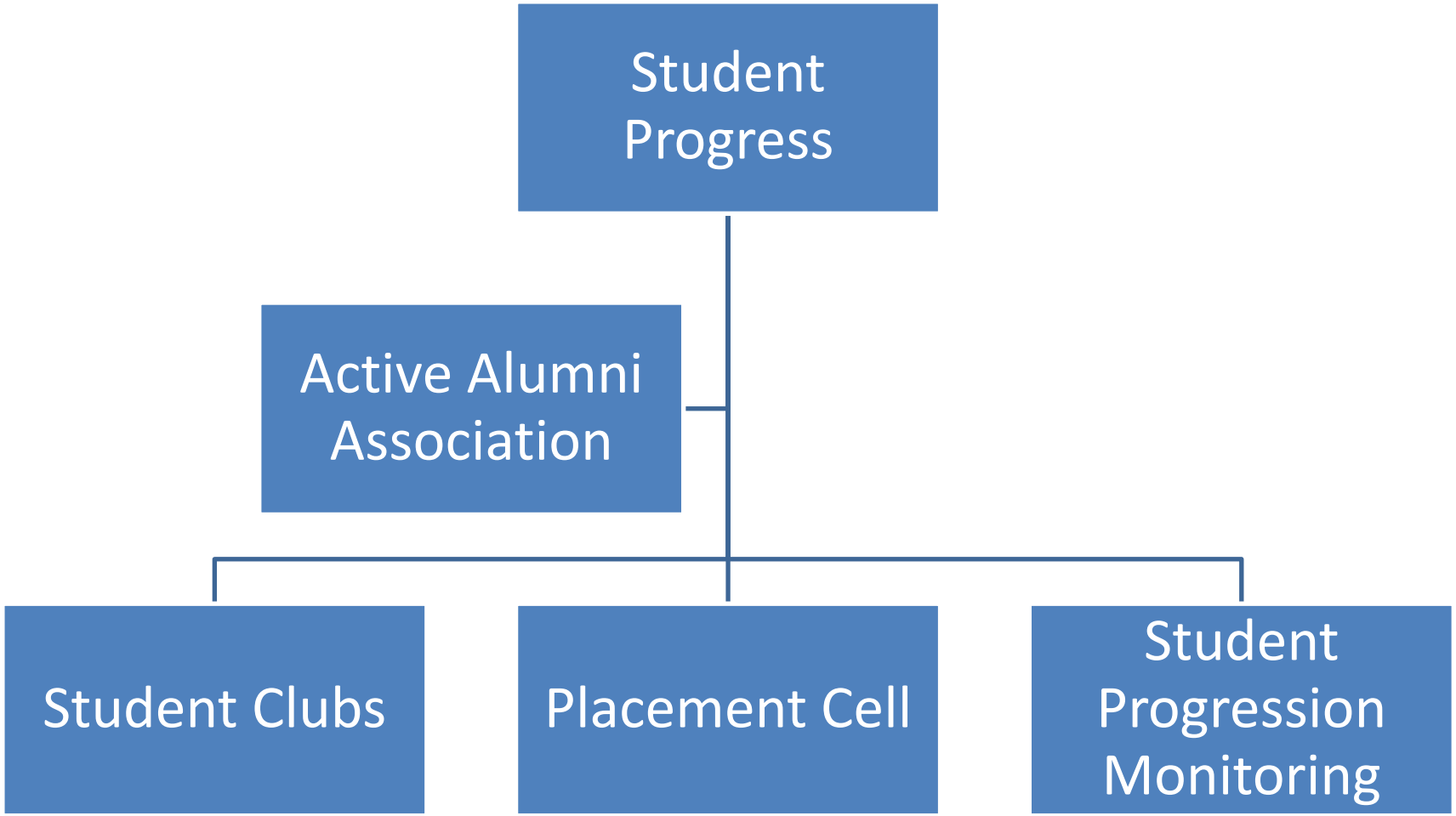
Best Practices – to improve the Rankings



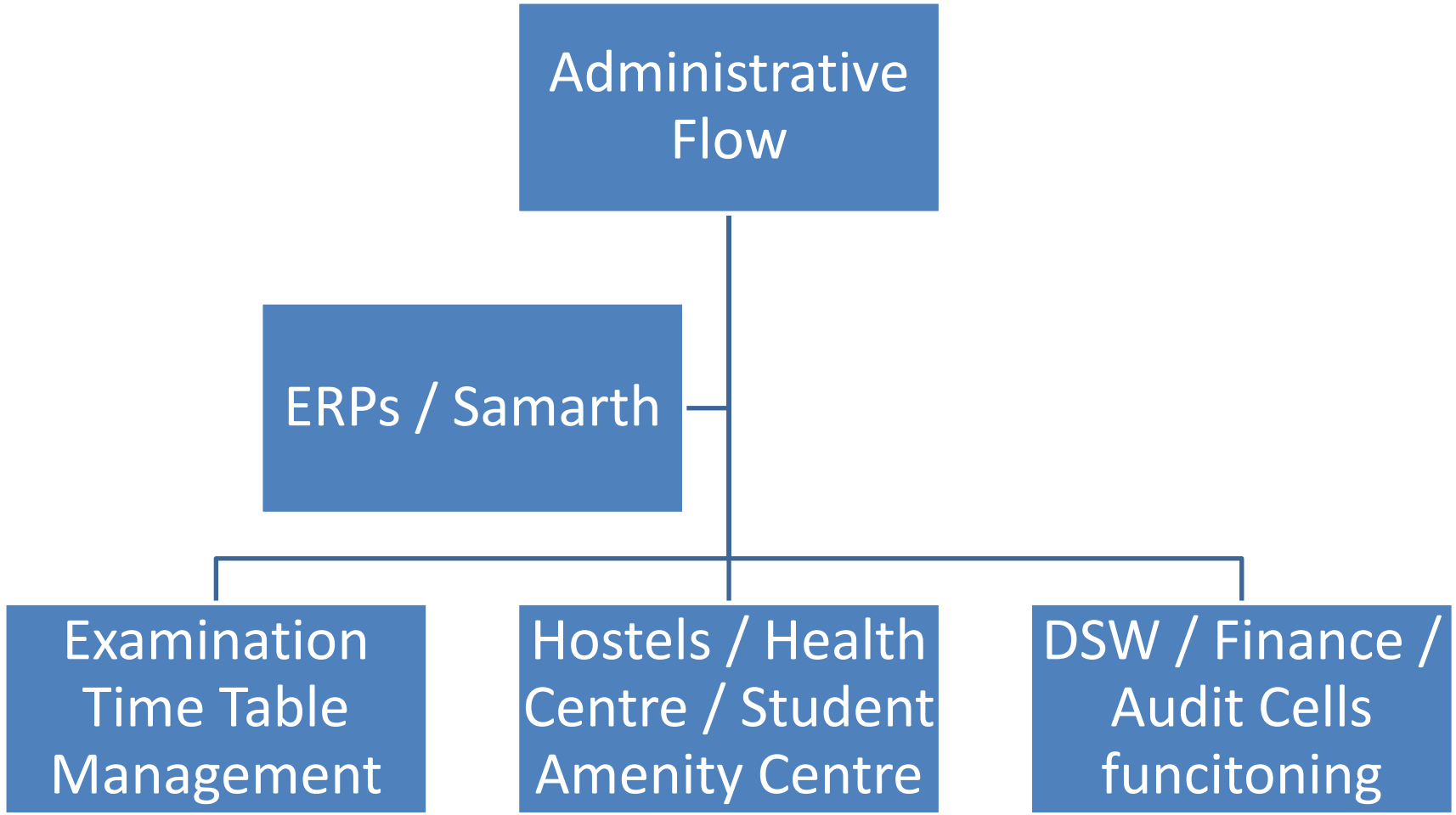
Best Practices – to improve the Rankings



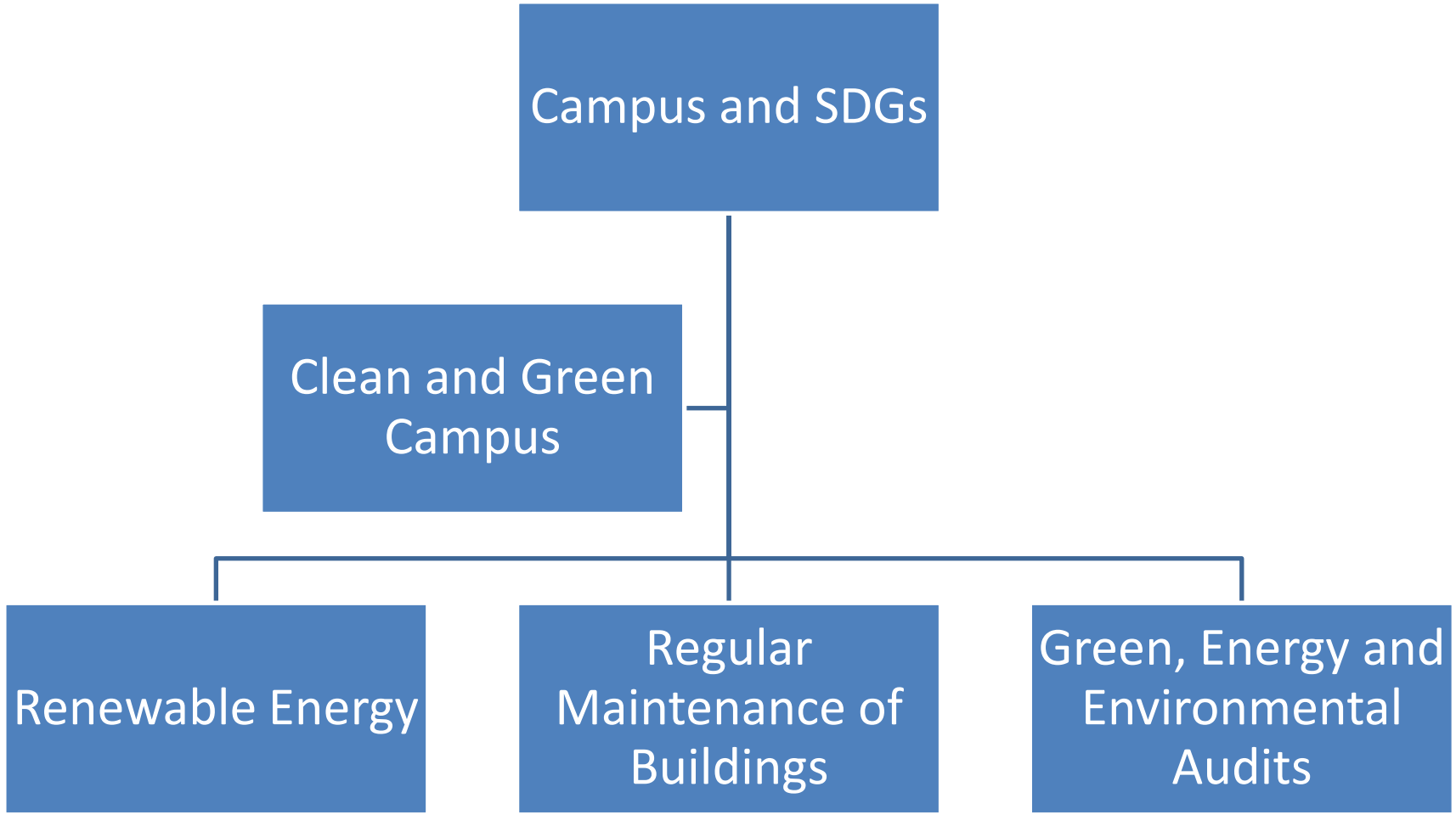
Best Practices – to improve the Rankings



Best Practices – to improve the Rankings



Best Practices – to improve the Rankings




Thank You